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AIRPORT CITIES

The runway dividend

Which land around a new airport gains value, for which uses and how fast: evidence from the Gulf, Egypt, Africa and Central Asia



CAIRO | DUBAI

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THE REPORT IN SIX NUMBERS

7 to 38

years after opening before Hong Kong, Incheon and Changi added destination real estate. Dubai South was launched four years before the first cargo flight at Al Maktoum International.

11 to 1

off-plan against resale apartment sales by value in Dubai South in 2025: AED 10.23 billion against AED 0.91 billion (Heirstone analysis).

0.16%

of value lost per decibel of aircraft noise by vacant land near Vancouver airport in a 1993 study, against 0.65 to 0.90% for homes.

47.1% to 0.3%

industrial rent premium of US airport submarkets over their metro areas, from O'Hare to Memphis. The premium is highest where land by the airfield is limited.

About 1,200

named hotel keys in three schemes beside the Grand Egyptian Museum: TMG's hotel of about 495 rooms, the 400-key Aldau GEM Hotel and the 303-room Sofitel Legend Pyramids Giza (Heirstone analysis).

5.8x

rise from 2024 to 2026 in the investment potential of New Tashkent's land, from US$0.6 million to US$3.5 million a hectare, as reported by the city's directorate before its airport opens.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report asks which land around a new airport gains value, for which uses and how fast, and who captures that value. It is written for master developers, government land agencies, airport owners and concession grantors, free-zone authorities, development finance institutions, and investors and operators in logistics, hotels, offices and housing near airports.

It draws on public sources current in 2026: airport operators, master developers, governments, regulators, listed-company filings, development finance institutions, academic studies and attributed market data. 2025 is the reference year. Where we combine published figures to produce a new one, such as jobs per hectare, plot ratio or investment per square metre of land, the calculation is labelled Heirstone analysis.

THE ARGUMENT

Land around a new airport is repriced on the programme, years before the passengers arrive. The dividend goes to whoever designates that land at year zero, releases it in the order that noise and scarcity allow, and links it to the city by rail.

WHAT WE FOUND

Land around a new airport is priced on the programme, years before the passengers arrive. Whoever controls and phases that land collects the dividend.

We dated the build-out of airport cities on four continents and assembled 32 of them into the Heirstone Airport Cities Benchmark 2026. The sequence of uses is stable; its speed, and who captures the value, are now set by land policy.

1 **The order of uses has held for fifty years. The clock has shortened.**

Freight and logistics come first, aviation business and offices next, destination uses and homes last. Hong Kong opened AsiaWorld-Expo seven years after its airport, Incheon its resorts 16 to 22 years after, Changi its Jewel after 38. Dubai South was launched in 2006, four years before Al Maktoum International's first cargo flight, and Senegal decreed a 718 ha zone beside Blaise Diagne International Airport in the airport's opening year.

2 **Noise decides the use and scarcity the price.**

US rules allow industry up to 85 DNL with insulation, offices to 80 and homes only below 65. Homes inside the contours lose about 0.5 to 1% of value per decibel; vacant land near Vancouver lost 0.16%. Industrial rents near US airports carry a 13% premium on average, from 47.1% at O'Hare, where land is scarce, to 0.3% at Memphis.

3 **Prices move years before the first flight.**

In Dubai South, developers sold AED 10.23 billion of apartments off plan in 2025, eleven times the value of resales, and apartment resale prices rose 27.6%, on a broker's analysis of Land Department records. New Tashkent's directorate puts the investment potential of its land at US$3.5 million a hectare in 2026, up from US$0.6 million in 2024.

4 **The dividend goes to whoever holds the land.**

Schiphol earns 8.5% of its revenue from rents on EUR 1.9 billion of investment property; Abu Dhabi's KEZAD reported AED 2.87 billion of revenue in 2025 at a 54% EBITDA margin; Egypt's ACUD reported EGP 19.8 billion of pre-tax profit for 2022. An owner that sells all its land at the first phase hands the later uplift to the buyer.

5 **Egypt has built both new kinds of gateway.**

Demand at Sphinx International Airport rose 30 to 35% after the Grand Egyptian Museum opened, according to the Egyptian Airports Company, and about 1,200 named hotel keys are planned beside the museum. Capital International Airport serves the New Administrative Capital, where more than 400 developers are active and the first international route opened in 2026. A 2026 directive on investment zones around airports makes both a national model.

WHAT IT MEANS

Governments and land agencies should designate airport-city land in the same decision as the airport, release it in tranches matched to demand, and build the rail link before the homes.

Airport owners should keep the land nearest the terminal and lease it, and sell where a partner brings an anchor tenant.

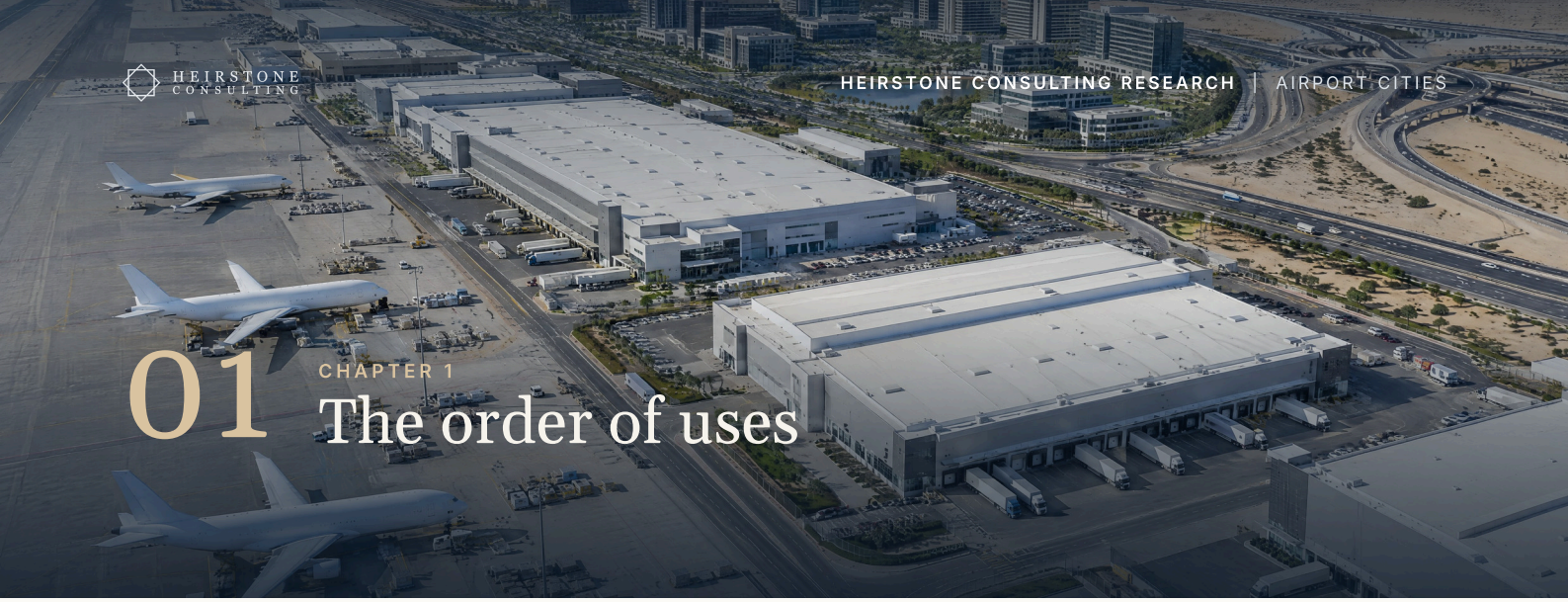
Developers and investors should buy the programme and the station, and price each parcel by its noise contour.

32

airport cities and airport-linked districts in the Heirstone Airport Cities Benchmark 2026

5 rungs

in the Heirstone Runway Ladder, from the cargo apron to family housing



CHAPTER 1

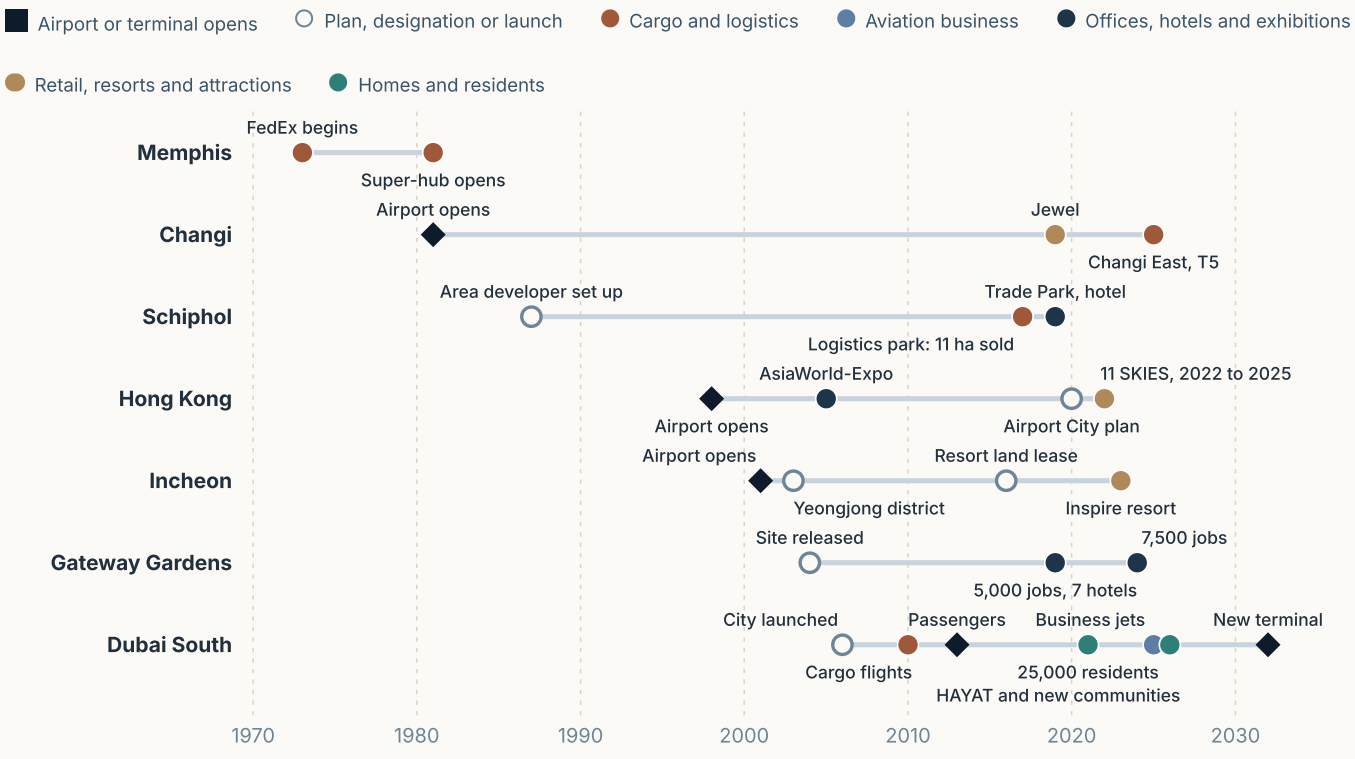
01 The order of uses

In the airport cities we dated, land filled in the same order: freight and logistics first, aviation business and offices next, hotels, attractions and homes last. What has changed is the clock. The pioneers took decades; the newest programmes designate the land before the first flight.

EXHIBIT 1

Seven airport cities, one sequence: cargo and aviation business first, destination uses and homes later

Dated milestones by use, from the first cargo or plan milestone to the latest published one; calendar years



Source: FedEx (history); Changi Airport Group; NTU Business School and AFP (2019); SADC (2017, 2018, 2019); Airport Authority Hong Kong (2018, 2020); Architizer, 11 SKIES (2022 to 2025); Incheon Free Economic Zone Authority; Korea Times (2016, 2023); Gateway Gardens (2019, 2024); Dubai Airports, DWC fact file; Dubai Media Office (2022); Dubai South (2026). Frankfurt's row starts when the site was released for development in 2004. 11 SKIES opened in phases from 2022 to 2025.

The sequence follows two constraints examined in Chapter 2: noise rules keep homes out of the loudest land, and freight is the only use that needs the airfield from the first day. Memphis is the simplest case. FedEx began there in 1973 and opened its super-hub in 1981; cargo now accounts for 91% of the airport's 35,540 direct jobs.

Dubai South compresses the sequence onto one site. Cargo flights at Al Maktoum International began in 2010, passengers in 2013, and residents numbered more than 25,000 by 2021. In 2025 three new residential launches sold out; in 2026 an AED 62 billion mixed-use community was agreed, six years before the new terminal's first phase.

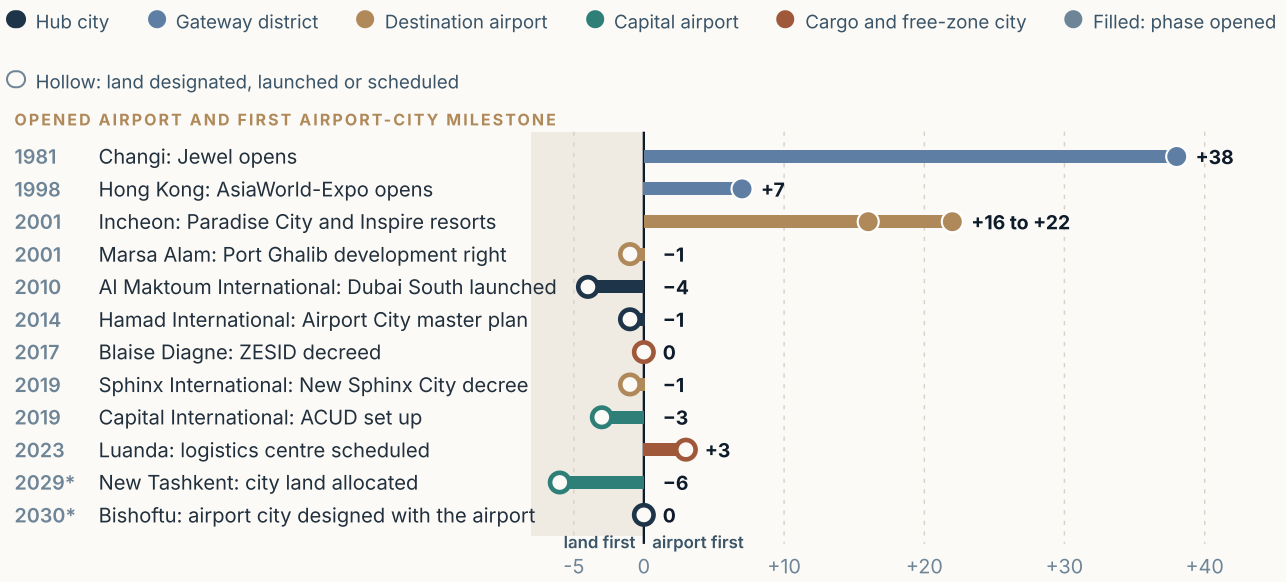
THE COMPRESSION CURVE

The pioneers took 7 to 38 years to add destination uses. The new programmes start at year zero.

EXHIBIT 2

Every airport in the sample that opened, or is due to open, from 2010 had airport-city land designated by its third year, most of them before the first flight

Years from airport opening to the first airport-city milestone, airports in order of opening; negative values mean the land came first; * planned opening; colour shows the Heirstone airport-city model



Source: Heirstone Airport Cities Benchmark 2026 (Exhibit 8): Changi Airport Group; Airport Authority Hong Kong (2018); Korea Times (2016, 2023); Sega Sammy (2017) for Paradise City's opening; MEED (2000) and Al Bawaba (2001); Dubai Media Office (2022) and Dubai Airports; Gulf Times (2013), Middle East Construction News (2013) and Qatar Airways (2014); APIX (2021); Asharq Al-Awsat (2019); Business Today Egypt and Airport Technology (2019); Aviation Week (2025); President of Uzbekistan press service (2023) and Kun.uz (2026); Dar Al-Handasah (2026) and AfDB (2025). Sphinx is dated from regular flights in 2019 and Capital International from trial flights in 2019. **Heirstone analysis.**

Hong Kong International opened in 1998 and added AsiaWorld-Expo, its first destination-scale venue, in 2005; 11 SKIES, up to 350,000 m² of retail, dining and entertainment in the 25 ha SKYCITY district, followed from 2022 to 2025. Incheon's Inspire resort, with 1,256 rooms and a 15,000-seat arena, opened in 2023 on land leased from the airport for 50 years. Changi opened in 1981 and Jewel, 135,700 m² in front of Terminal 1, in 2019. Frankfurt's Gateway Gardens, released for development in 2004, had more than 5,000 jobs by 2019, a fifth of the 25,000 planned.

The programmes started since 2000 run the clock the other way. Dubai South was launched in 2006 as a 145 km² city; Senegal's 718 ha zone was decreed in Blaise Diagne International Airport's opening year; New Sphinx City was created in 2018 as trial flights began at Sphinx International Airport; and New Tashkent received 19,720 ha in 2023, about six years before its airport is due.

Designation settles who owns the uplift. Around the pioneers, neighbouring owners captured the rise in value plot by plot. Where one agency holds and services the land before the airport opens, it can release that land in phases and set the price of each release.

7 years

from Hong Kong International's opening to AsiaWorld-Expo

38 years

from Changi's opening to Jewel

2006

Dubai South launched, four years before the first cargo flight at Al Maktoum International

CHAPTER 2

02

Where the value lands

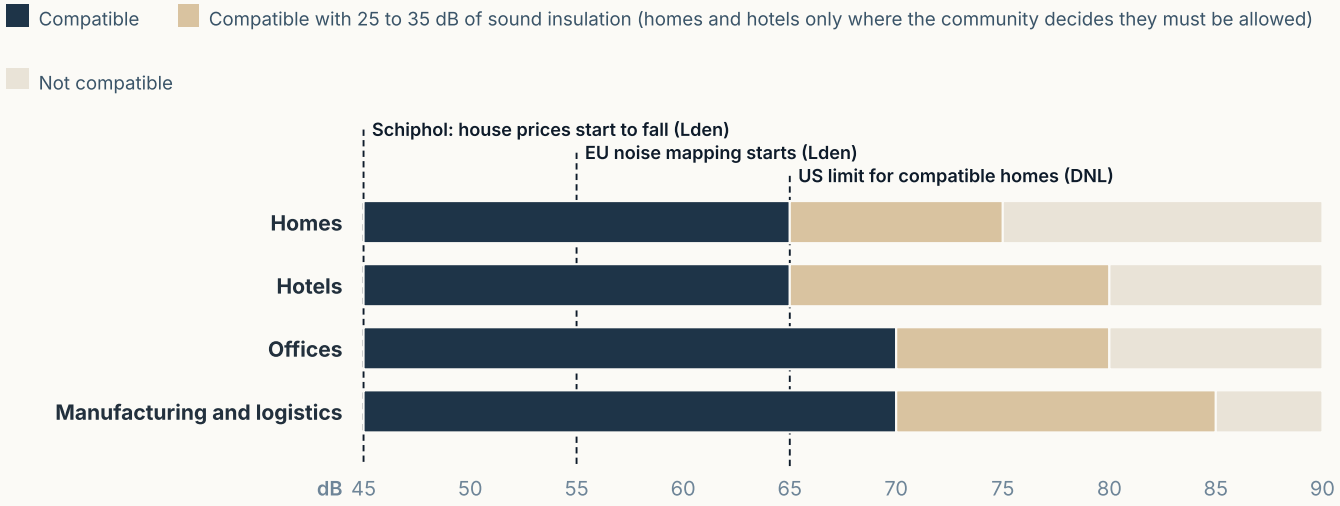
An airport raises the value of some land and lowers the value of other land a few kilometres away. Three things decide which: the noise contour a parcel sits in, how scarce land is beside the airfield, and how quickly the parcel reaches the city.

The rules on noise come first because they fix what can be built where. ICAO lists land-use planning as one of the four elements of its Balanced Approach to aircraft noise, adopted in 2001, and national rules turn that into contours.

EXHIBIT 3

Homes stop at 65 DNL, offices at 80 and industry at 85: the noisiest land suits logistics

US federal land-use compatibility by day-night noise level (DNL, dB), with European reference points measured in Lden



Source: US eCFR, 14 CFR Part 150, Appendix A, Table 1; EUR-Lex, Directive 2002/49/EC on environmental noise; Tinbergen Institute discussion paper TI 2008-064/3 (Schiphol). DNL and Lden are similar day-evening-night weighted measures but are not identical.

The US table is the most detailed public rulebook. Homes are compatible only below 65 DNL; between 65 and 75 they are allowed only where a community decides they must be, with 25 to 30 dB of sound insulation, and above 75 not at all. Hotels follow the same rule up to 80 DNL. Offices are compatible to 70 and to 80 with insulation. Manufacturing is compatible to 70 and still permitted to 85 if its offices are insulated.

In Europe the rules map noise. The Environmental Noise Directive makes airports with more than 50,000 movements a year report exposure in bands from 55 dB Lden and lists land-use planning among the measures an action plan can use. Markets react sooner than the maps: around Schiphol, house prices start to fall from 45 dB, ten decibels below the reporting floor. Safeguarding takes land too. At Schiphol Trade Park, the area developer keeps the first 600 metres from the A4 motorway free of buildings because of airport-related restrictions.

65 DNL
US limit for compatible housing near airports

85 DNL
manufacturing and logistics still permitted, with insulated offices

45 dB
Lden level at which Schiphol house prices begin to fall

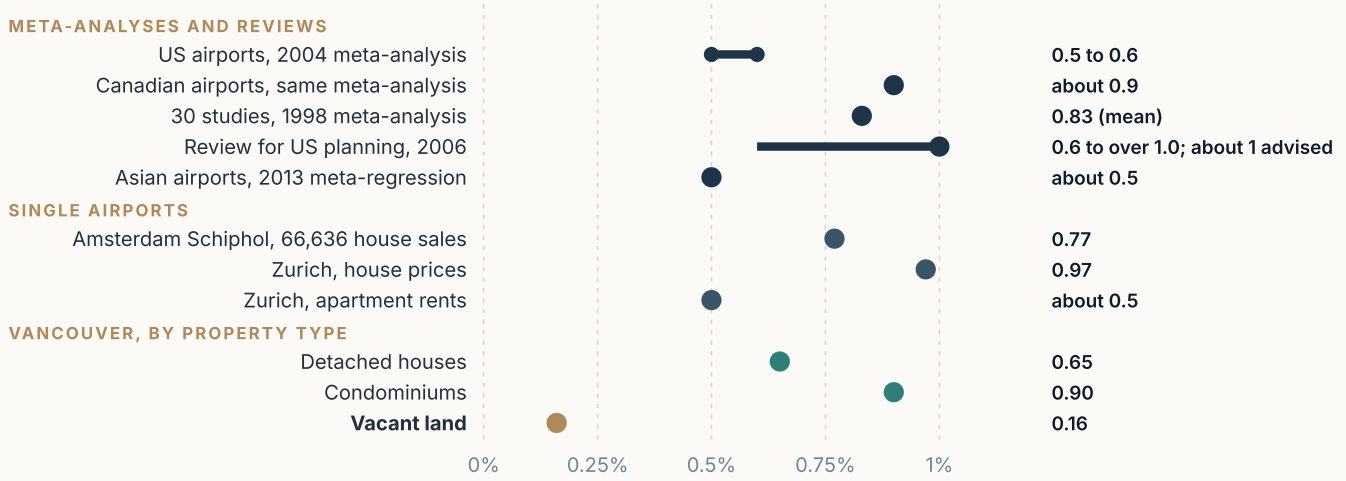
NOISE AND SCARCITY

Homes pay for noise; warehouses pay for scarcity

EXHIBIT 4

Homes inside the contours lose about 0.5 to 1% of value per decibel; vacant land near Vancouver lost 0.16%

Noise depreciation index: % change in house price, rent or land value per 1 dB of aircraft noise

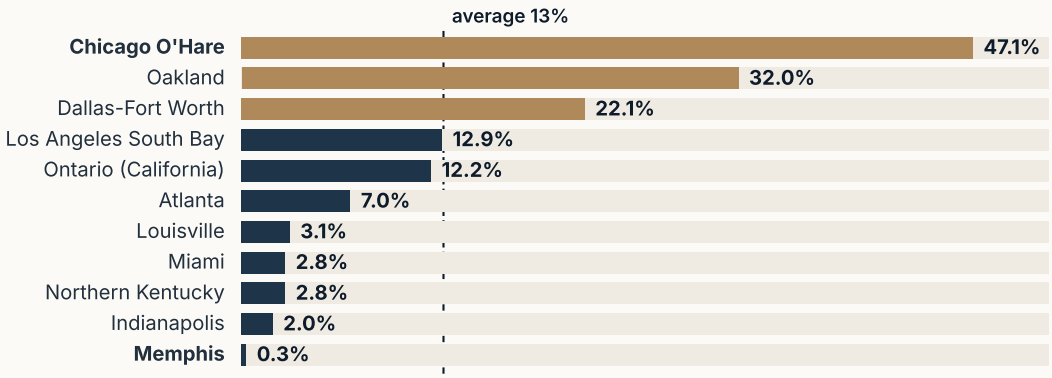


Source: Journal of Transport Economics and Policy 38(1), 2004, as cited in Asian Geographer 30(2), 2013; GRA Inc., technical note on aircraft noise (2006), citing a 1998 meta-analysis and a 1993 Vancouver International Airport study; Asian Geographer 30(2), 2013; Tinbergen Institute TI 2008-064/3; Swiss Journal of Economics and Statistics 144, 2008; Journal of Urban Economics 69(2), 2011. Studies use different noise measures, so values are indicative.

EXHIBIT 5

Industrial rents near US airports carry an average 13% premium, highest where land beside the airfield is scarce

Industrial rent premium of 11 airport submarkets over their metro markets, 2021 (%)



Source: CBRE research (2021), as reported by AJOT. Rent comparisons, not hedonic estimates.

The housing evidence is consistent. Pooled North American estimates give 0.5 to 0.6% per decibel in the US and about 0.9% in Canada; 66,636 sales around Schiphol give 0.77%, and homes in its 50 to 55 dB band sold about 12% below those under 35 dB. A natural experiment in Zurich found rents fell about 0.5% per decibel. Near Atlanta, homes in the 70 to 75 DNL zone sold 20.8% below quieter homes, yet once noise is held constant proximity is an amenity: homes 10% farther from the airport sold for about 1.5% less.

For a landowner the smallest number matters most. Vacant land near Vancouver lost 0.16% per decibel, a quarter of the discount on detached houses, which suggests that noisy land loses most of its value when it is zoned for homes. Industrial land runs the other way, and its premium follows scarcity: 47.1% at O'Hare, in a dense metro, and 0.3% at Memphis, home of the FedEx super-hub. Offices need more than proximity: a 2009 rail line to Vancouver airport had no significant average effect on 2,059 commercial sales in Richmond, British Columbia.

WHO CAPTURES THE UPLIFT

An owner that keeps the land keeps the dividend; one that sells early passes it on

EXHIBIT 6

Six ways to hold airport-city land, from the airport company's balance sheet to a state master developer

Holding models observed in the Heirstone Airport Cities Benchmark 2026, with published evidence on what each earns

HOLDING MODEL	HOW THE OWNER EARNS	EXAMPLES AND EVIDENCE	WHAT THE OWNER KEEPS
Airport company holds and lets	Rents from offices, logistics, hotels and car rental on airport land	Amsterdam Schiphol: rents and leases of EUR 234 million in 2025, 8.5% of group revenue; investment property of EUR 1.89 billion (2026); an area developer for the airport region since 1987	Most of the uplift, and the leasing risk
Joint venture on airport land	A share of the income and value of a development partner's scheme	Singapore: Changi Airport Group holds 51% of Jewel. Frankfurt: Gateway Gardens is a joint project of the airport, two developers and the city	A share of the uplift; the partner brings capital and tenants
Long lease to a private developer	Ground rent, with the land returning at the end of the term	Incheon: a 50-year lease of 2.6 km² for the Inspire resort, a project put at US$5 billion. Istanbul: a 2,600 ha Airport City inside a 25-year airport lease	Ground rent and the reversion
State master developer	Sale or lease of serviced plots to developers, phase by phase	Dubai South, 145 km². Egypt's ACUD at the New Administrative Capital: EGP 300 billion of land returns expected (2022) and EGP 19.8 billion of pre-tax profit (2022). NUCA at New Sphinx City	Land value at each release; the developer carries the build risk
Free-zone or SEZ operator	Leases and licence fees from firms in the zone	Abu Dhabi's KEZAD: AED 2.87 billion revenue in 2025 at a 54% EBITDA margin, with 73.6 km² leased. Rwanda's Bugesera SEZ: a US$100 million public-private partnership	Recurring income tied to activity
Airport concession with a land bank	Airport operation plus development rights on nearby land	Egypt: Marsa Alam International, the country's first private build-operate-transfer airport (40 years, won 1997), with 22 million m² at Port Ghalib, 5 km away, for the same sponsor	The uplift the airport creates on its own land bank

Source: Royal Schiphol Group, 2025 annual results and 2026 half-year results; SADC (2017); Changi Airport Group and Moodie Davitt Report (2013); Gateway Gardens (2019); Korea Times (2016); iGA Istanbul Airport; Dubai Media Office (2022); El Watan News (2022) and Amwal Al Ghad (2023) reporting ACUD; Asharq Al-Awsat (2019); KEZAD Group; Arise IIP; Al Bawaba (2001); MEED (2000). Schiphol's revenue share is **Heirstone analysis.**

The choice of model decides who collects the dividend. Schiphol has held its land and built a property business on it: rents and leases rose 17% to EUR 234 million in 2025, lifted by the purchase of further World Trade Center towers, and its investment property was carried at EUR 1.89 billion in its 2026 half-year accounts, EUR 427 million of it land. Its area developer, set up in 1987, sold 11 ha of a logistics park of more than 50 ha in 2017.

Changi and Frankfurt shared the risk with developers; Incheon leased the land and kept the reversion. The state master developer is the model of the Gulf and Egypt. It suits a new city: one owner sets the order of release, funds the infrastructure from early sales and keeps later phases for the higher prices the programme creates.

Jobs follow function as much as land. Memphis supports 35,540 direct jobs on 4.9 million passengers, about 7.3 per 1,000 passengers against 0.95 across European airports, because most of its work is cargo.

8.5%

of Schiphol's 2025 revenue came from rents and leases (Heirstone analysis)

54%

EBITDA margin at Abu Dhabi's KEZAD on AED 2.87 billion of 2025 revenue

7.3

direct jobs per 1,000 passengers at cargo-led Memphis, against 0.95 in Europe (Heirstone analysis)

THE HEIRSTONE AIRPORT CITIES BENCHMARK 2026

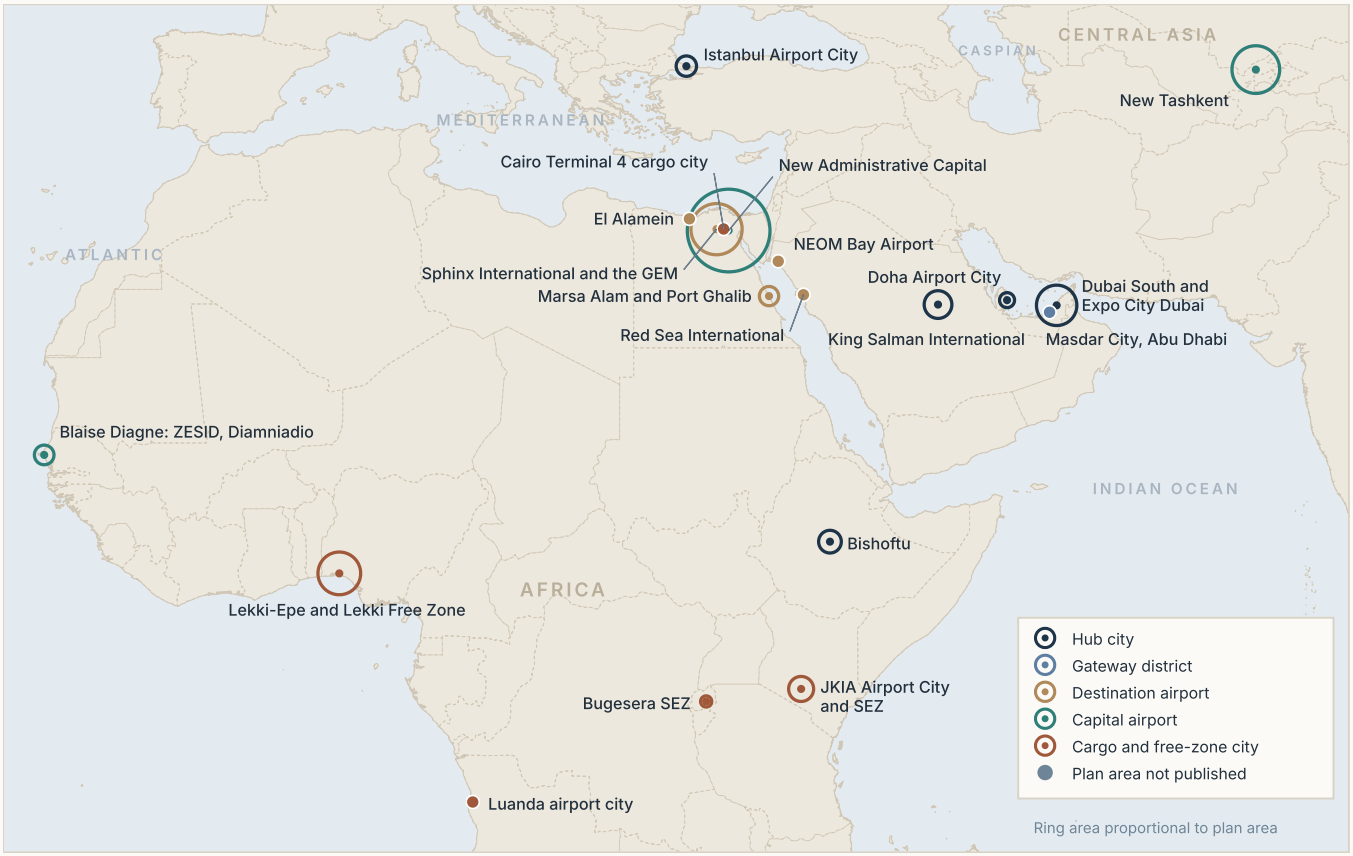
Thirty-two airport cities, five models

We assembled 32 airport cities and airport-linked districts, 23 of them in the Gulf, Egypt, Africa and Central Asia, with their land, jobs, floor space, timing and holding model. Each falls into one of five models, which explain most of the differences in scale and density between them.

EXHIBIT 7

From Dakar to New Tashkent, the newest airport cities pair the runway with large reserves of land

Airport cities and airport-linked districts in the benchmark, by model and plan area; European, East Asian and North American references are listed in Exhibit 8



Source: Heirstone Airport Cities Benchmark 2026 (Exhibit 8). Coordinates from GeoNames airport or place records. King Salman International uses the King Khalid International point, Sphinx and New Sphinx City the airport point, Masdar City the Zayed International point, El Alamein the town, Bishoftu the town, Lekki the Ibeju Lekki area, Bugesera the district and New Tashkent the Nurafshon district seat, so those positions are approximate. New Tashkent's ring shows city and airport land together.

MODEL	WHAT IT IS	MARKERS IN THE BENCHMARK	EXAMPLES
Hub city	A city-scale plan around a transfer hub: logistics and aviation business first, then workforce and family housing.	Plan areas of 1,000 to 14,500 ha; up to about two hectares of city per hectare of airport.	Dubai South, King Salman International, Doha, Istanbul, Bishoftu
Gateway district	A dense, rail-linked district of offices, hotels, exhibitions and retail on or beside the terminal.	3.5 to 350 ha; plot ratio 1.4 to 3.9; about 200 to 700 jobs or residents a hectare.	Frankfurt, Hong Kong, Changi, Schiphol, Expo City Dubai, Masdar City
Destination airport	An airport built for a destination, where hotels and attractions are the first land use.	Measured in hotel keys and visitor caps.	Sphinx and the Grand Egyptian Museum, Red Sea International, NEOM Bay, Marsa Alam
Capital airport	An airport built with a new capital or new city, where the city comes first or alongside.	City land about 15 times the airport's at New Tashkent; 714 km² at the New Administrative Capital.	Capital International and the New Administrative Capital, New Tashkent, Diamniadio
Cargo and free-zone city	Logistics and fiscal zones lead; value rests on customs status and land by the apron or port.	Zones of about 300 to 55,000 ha; low job density per hectare.	Memphis, Cairo Terminal 4, Changi East, Lekki, Bugesera, ZESID, JKIA, Luanda

THE HEIRSTONE AIRPORT CITIES BENCHMARK 2026

The Gulf and Egypt

Shaded columns are Heirstone analysis from the published inputs. Blank cells were not published or could not be verified. Years from opening are negative where the land was designated or launched before the airport opened. 1 feddan = 4,200.83 m².

EXHIBIT 8

The Heirstone Airport Cities Benchmark 2026 (part 1 of 2)

AIRPORT CITY OR DISTRICT AND AIRPORT	MODEL	PLAN AREA (HA)	AIRPORT LAND (HA)	CITY TO AIRPORT LAND (X)	JOBS, PEOPLE OR SCALE	PER HA	PLOT RATIO	AIRPORT OPENED	FIRST AIRPORT-CITY MILESTONE	YEARS FROM OPENING
THE GULF										
Dubai South Al Maktoum International (DWC), Dubai, UAE	Hub city	14,500	7,000	2.1	500,000 jobs (plan)	34		2010	2006: city launched	−4
Expo City Dubai beside DWC, Dubai, UAE	Gateway district	350			35,000 residents, 40,000 professionals (plan)	214		2010		
Emaar South DWC, Dubai, UAE	Hub city				22,700 homes (plan)			2010		
King Salman International support zone KSIA, Riyadh, Saudi Arabia	Hub city	1,200	5,700	0.21	103,000 jobs, airport-wide (target)			new airport	2022: master plan with real estate	with airport
The Red Sea destination Red Sea International (RSI), Saudi Arabia	Destination airport				1 million visitor cap; 18 hotels, about 3,000 keys			2023		
NEOM NEOM Bay Airport, Saudi Arabia	Destination airport							2019	2019: NEOM's first operational asset	0
Doha Airport City Hamad International (DOH), Qatar	Hub city	1,000			200,000 living and working (plan)	200		2014	2013: master plan	−1
Masdar City Zayed International (AUH), Abu Dhabi, UAE	Gateway district				Masdar City Square 50,000 m² GFA					
KEZAD (port-led reference) Khalifa Port cluster, Abu Dhabi, UAE	Cargo and free-zone city	55,000			164,000+ jobs	22 per leased ha				
EGYPT										
New Sphinx City and the Sphinx corridor Sphinx International (SPX), Giza, Egypt	Destination airport	24,950			Parcels of 336 ha (TBK), 210 ha (Emaar Misr), 188 ha (SODIC)			2019	2018: New Sphinx City decree	−1
Grand Egyptian Museum hotel zone Sphinx International (SPX), Giza, Egypt	Destination airport	22			About 1,200 named hotel keys in the pipeline			2019	2020: hotel-zone plan reviewed	1
New Administrative Capital Capital International (CCE), Egypt	Capital airport	71,414			40,000 government staff (2023)			2019	2016: ACUD set up	−3
Cairo Terminal 4 cargo city Cairo International (CAI), Egypt	Cargo and free-zone city				1 million t a year, expandable to 2 million				2025: announced with Terminal 4	
Port Ghalib Marsa Alam International (RMF), Egypt	Destination airport	2,200			1,000-berth marina			2001	2000: development right granted	−1
New Alamein El Alamein International (DBB), Egypt	Destination airport				266,600 passengers in seven months of 2026 (+57%)					

Source: Dubai Media Office (2022, 2024); Dubai Airports, DWC fact file; Dubai South (2025, 2026); Expo City Dubai, master plan brochure; Emaar Properties; Saudi Press Agency (2024); Moodie Davitt Report (2022); MEED (2025); Red Sea Global; NEOM; Gulf Times (2013); Middle East Construction News (2013); Qatar Airways (2014); Masdar City; KEZAD Group; Asharq Al-Awsat (2019); Daily News Egypt (2025); Bnok24 (2024); Invest-Gate (2020, 2026); Amwal Al Ghad (2020); Hospitality Net (2024); IFC disclosures (2026); Zawya; Presidency of Egypt; El Watan News (2016, 2022); Business Today Egypt; Cairo Governorate (2023); Ahram Online (2026); Egyptian State Information Service (2025); MEED (2000); Al Bawaba (2001); Daily News Egypt citing IDSC (2026). KSIA's 1,200 ha is its support-facility zone within a 5,700 ha master plan. Capital International's site area is left blank until a primary source publishes it.

THE HEIRSTONE AIRPORT CITIES BENCHMARK 2026, CONTINUED

References, Africa and Central Asia

EXHIBIT 8

The Heirstone Airport Cities Benchmark 2026 (part 2 of 2)

AIRPORT CITY OR DISTRICT AND AIRPORT	MODEL	PLAN AREA (HA)	AIRPORT LAND (HA)	CITY TO AIRPORT LAND (X)	JOBS, PEOPLE OR SCALE	PER HA	PLOT RATIO	AIRPORT OPENED	FIRST AIRPORT-CITY MILESTONE	YEARS FROM OPENING
EUROPE, ASIA AND NORTH AMERICA										
Schiphol logistics and trade parks Amsterdam Schiphol (AMS), Netherlands	Gateway district	50							1987: area developer set up	
Gateway Gardens Frankfurt (FRA), Germany	Gateway district	35			7,500 jobs (2024); 25,000 at completion	214 / 714	2.3		2004: site released	
SKYCITY and AsiaWorld-Expo Hong Kong International (HKG)	Gateway district	36			11 SKIES: up to 350,000 m² GFA		1.4	1998	2005: AsiaWorld-Expo	7
Jewel Changi Airport Singapore Changi (SIN)	Gateway district	3.5			135,700 m² of floor space		3.9	1981	2019: Jewel	38
Changi East Singapore Changi (SIN)	Cargo and free-zone city	1,080			Cargo capacity to 5.4 million t			1981	2025: Terminal 5 groundbreaking	44
Inspire and Paradise City resorts Seoul Incheon (ICN), Korea	Destination airport	430			Inspire phase 1: 1,256 rooms			2001	2017 and 2023: resorts	16 to 22
Yeongjong International City Seoul Incheon (ICN), Korea	Hub city	5,118						2001	2003: district programme	2
Istanbul Airport City Istanbul Airport (IST), Turkiye	Hub city	2,600			45 ha Central Area			2018	planned	
FedEx World Hub area Memphis International (MEM), US	Cargo and free-zone city				35,540 direct jobs (2024)				1981: FedEx super-hub	
AFRICA AND CENTRAL ASIA										
Bishoftu Airport City Bishoftu International (new), Ethiopia	Hub city	3,500			Site for airport and airport city			2029 to 2030 (target)	designed with the airport	0
Bugesera Special Economic Zone Bugesera International (new), Rwanda	Cargo and free-zone city	336						2027 to 2028 (target)	zone before airport	before
Lekki Free Trade Zone Lekki-Epe International (proposed), Nigeria	Cargo and free-zone city	16,500	3,500	4.7	110 ha sold to 16 investors (2025)			proposed	free zone before airport	before
Integrated Special Economic Zone (ZESID) Blaise Diagne International (AIBD), Senegal	Cargo and free-zone city	718						2017	2017: zone decreed	0
Diamniadio urban pole Blaise Diagne International (AIBD), Senegal	Capital airport	1,644			557 jobs at the P2ID industrial park (2021)	43 (P2ID)		2017	2018: ministries due to move	1
JKIA Airport City and SEZ Jomo Kenyatta International (JKIA), Kenya	Cargo and free-zone city		4,452						2026: land reserved in master plan	
Luanda airport city Dr Antonio Agostinho Neto International, Angola	Cargo and free-zone city							2023	2026: logistics centre scheduled	3
New Tashkent New Tashkent International (new), Uzbekistan	Capital airport	19,720	1,310	15.1				2029 (target)	2023: city land allocated	−6

Source: Royal Schiphol Group; SADC (2017, 2018, 2019); Gateway Gardens (2019, 2024); Airport Authority Hong Kong (2018); Architizer; Changi Airport Group; NTU Business School and AFP (2019); Moodie Davitt Report (2013); Incheon International Airport Corporation; Korea Times (2016, 2023); GGB Magazine (2015) and Sega Sammy (2017); Incheon Free Economic Zone Authority; iGA Istanbul Airport; Memphis-Shelby County Airport Authority and InterVISTAS (2026); FedEx; US International Trade Administration (2025); Dar Al-Handasah (2026); ZHA and AfDB (2025, 2026); Bugesera SEZ and Arise IIP; The New Times (2024); Federal Ministry of Information, Nigeria (2025); Estate Intel (2026); APIX (2021); Au Senegal (2018); AIBD SA; Kenya Airports Authority, JKIA master plan (2026); Aviation Week (2025); China Daily (2023); President of Uzbekistan press service (2023); Interfax and Kun.uz (2026). Inspire's site was 2.6 km² in the 2016 lease and 4.3 million m² in 2023 reports; the table uses the 2023 figure. Gateway Gardens shows jobs per ha now and at completion.

Hub city · Gateway district · Destination airport · Capital airport · Cargo and free-zone city

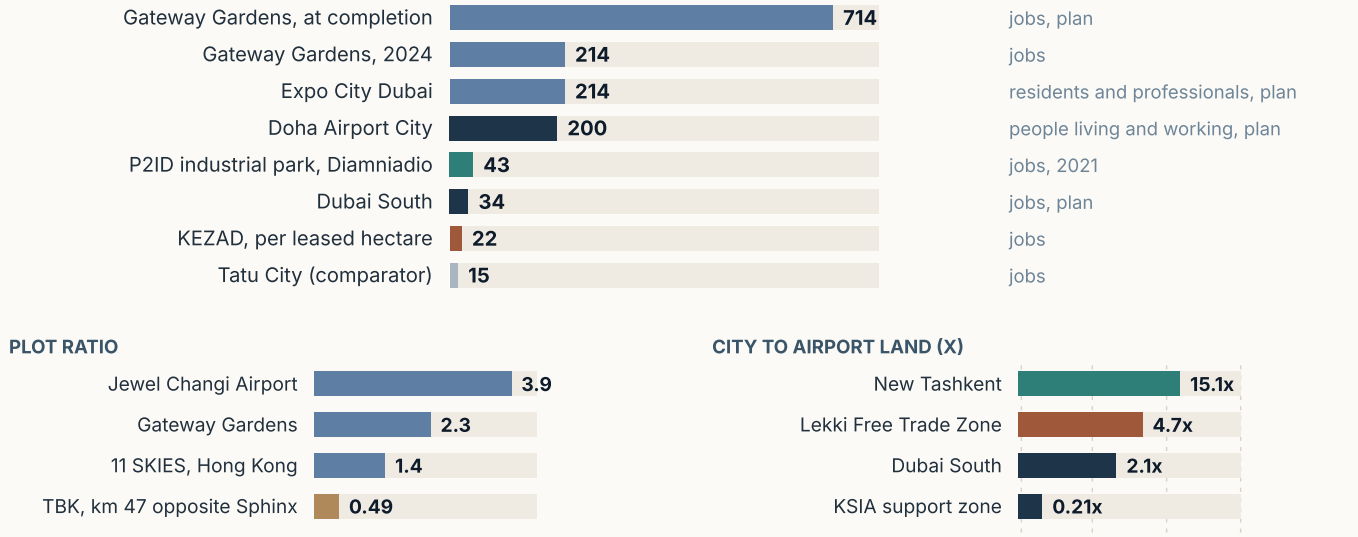
THE BENCHMARK: DENSITY, INTENSITY AND REACH

Density runs from 714 jobs a hectare at Gateway Gardens to 22 at KEZAD

EXHIBIT 9

Density, plot ratio and land reach separate the five models

Top: planned or current jobs or people per hectare. Bottom left: plot ratio, gross floor area over site area. Bottom right: airport-city land per hectare of airport land (log scale)



Source: Heirstone Airport Cities Benchmark 2026: Gateway Gardens (2024); Expo City Dubai master plan; Middle East Construction News (2013); APIX (2021); Dubai Media Office (2022); KEZAD Group; Rendeavour; NTU Business School, AFP and Moodie Davitt Report (2013); Architizer; Daily News Egypt (2025); President of Uzbekistan press service and Interfax (2026); Estate Intel (2026); Federal Ministry of Information, Nigeria (2025); Dubai Airports and AGBI (2026); Moodie Davitt Report (2022) and Saudi Press Agency (2024). Jewel's site is 377,000 sq ft. **Heirstone analysis.**

Density separates the models. Gateway Gardens, beside Frankfurt's terminals, has 214 jobs a hectare today and plans 714; the published plans for Expo City Dubai and Doha Airport City, counting residents and workers together, come to about 200 people a hectare. City-scale plans spread wider. Dubai South's 500,000 jobs on 145 km^2 come to about 34 a hectare, because the plan holds an airport, a logistics district, golf communities and a residential city. Industrial zones run lower still: KEZAD's 164,000 jobs come to about 22 per leased hectare.

Plot ratios follow position. Jewel stacks 135,700 m^2 on a 3.5 ha former car park in front of Terminal 1, a plot ratio of 3.9; Gateway Gardens plans 2.3 and 11 SKIES 1.4. Corridor housing schemes are lower: TBK's project opposite Sphinx International builds 104,000 m^2 on 212,000 m^2, about 0.49. The ratio of city land to airport land follows the model. King Salman International keeps its support zone within the airport, at 0.21 ha per hectare of airport; Dubai South has about two hectares of city per hectare of airport; New Tashkent, a capital airport, has about 15.

714

jobs per hectare planned at Gateway Gardens, the densest district in the benchmark

3.9

plot ratio of Jewel Changi Airport

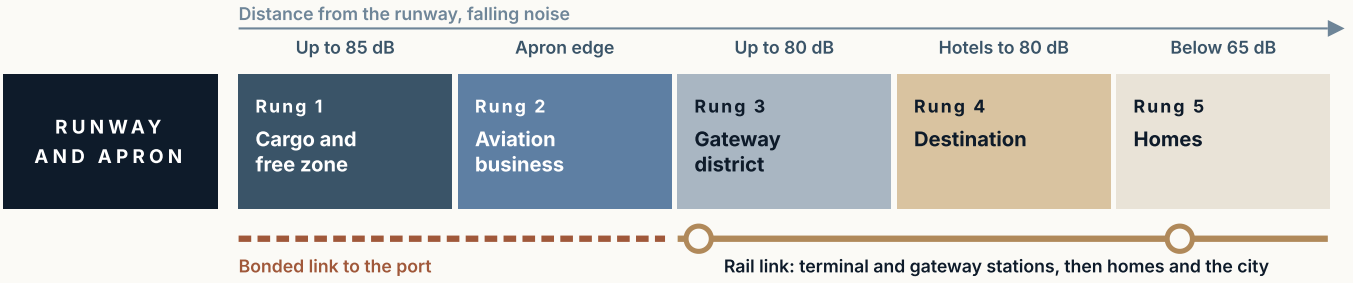
THE HEIRSTONE RUNWAY LADDER

Which use belongs on which parcel, and when to release it

EXHIBIT 10

The Heirstone Runway Ladder: five rungs from the cargo apron to family housing, each with thresholds from the benchmark

Schematic of uses by noise and distance (not to scale), and the thresholds for each rung



RUNG	USES	NOISE CEILING AND POSITION	DENSITY BENCHMARK	WHEN IT ARRIVES	VALUE SIGNAL	IN THE GULF AND EGYPT
1 Cargo and free zone	Cargo terminals, forwarders, bonded logistics, light industry	To 85 DNL with insulated offices; apron edge, bonded link to the port	About 22 jobs per leased ha (KEZAD)	Year zero: cargo at DWC in 2010	Rent premium of 0.3 to 47%, set by scarcity	Logistics District; KSIA cargo buildings; Cairo Terminal 4 cargo city
2 Aviation business	Business aviation, hangars, supplier units, airline offices	Apron frontage; offices to 80 DNL	Complexes of 16,661 to 24,900 m² (MBRAH)	Year one at DWC: general aviation from 2011	Earns rent before the airlines move	MBRAH; KSIA private aviation terminal
3 Gateway district	Offices, hotels, exhibitions, retail	To 80 DNL insulated; 2 minutes by rail from the terminal	Plot ratio 1.4 to 3.9; 200 to 714 jobs or residents per ha	7 to 15 years at the pioneers; with the terminal in new plans	Needs the rail link; proximity alone added no premium in Richmond	KSIA real estate; Doha Business District; Masdar City; Expo City Dubai
4 Destination	Museums, resorts, arenas and their hotels	Hotels to 80 DNL insulated; at the attraction	303 to about 495 keys per scheme beside the GEM	Day one where the attraction exists; 7 to 38 years where it is built	About US$397,000 per key at Sofitel Legend Pyramids	GEM hotels; The Red Sea; AMAALA
5 Homes	Workforce and family homes, schools	Below 65 DNL, best below 55; on the rail line	Communities of 2,500 to 22,700 homes	Once jobs and rail are in place	0.5 to 1% less per dB inside contours; an amenity outside	Emaar South; HAYAT; New Administrative Capital

Source: Heirstone framework. Thresholds from Exhibits 3 to 9 and the sources listed there; Dubai South (2025, 2026); MEED (2025); SteelOrbis (2026); Hospitality Net and Egyptian Streets (2024, 2025); Zawya; IFC disclosures (2026); Korea Times (2023); Emaar Properties. **Heirstone analysis.**

The ladder turns the evidence into a test any owner of land near an airport can apply. Each rung has a noise ceiling, a position, a density and a time at which demand arrived in the benchmark. A parcel goes to the highest-value rung it qualifies for and is released when the rung below it has been absorbed. Homes placed on rung-one land carry the noise discount, and logistics placed on rung-five land takes quiet land that housing could use.

The ladder also shows where the dividend sits. Rungs one and two earn early, and their premium depends on keeping land scarce. Rungs three and four carry the most planned investment per square metre in the benchmark and depend on the rail link. Rung five carries the largest volumes and is priced on the programme, as Dubai South's off-plan market shows.

FOUR TESTS FOR EVERY PARCEL

1. Contour
Which noise band is the parcel in today, and in the airport's final layout?

2. Distance
How far is it from the apron, the terminal and the city centre?

3. Rail
Is a station within walking distance, and in which year does it open?

4. Phase
How many years until the next airport phase, and which rungs below it are already absorbed?

CHAPTER 3

03 Dubai South and Al Maktoum International: the whole sequence on one site

EXHIBIT 11

Dubai South sits between the old airport, the port and Expo City Dubai

Dubai International (DXB), Al Maktoum International at Dubai World Central (DWC), Dubai South, Expo City Dubai and Jebel Ali Port



Source: GeoNames records for DXB, DWC, Jebel Ali Port and Dubai South (Madinat Al Mataar, used for its centre). Expo City Dubai and Downtown Dubai are approximate positions. Line routes are schematic; distances are straight-line Heirstone calculations, except the published 55 km of the Airport Express Line. The Dubai South districts, including Emaar South, are not separately located in GeoNames and are listed in Exhibit 12.

Dubai South is the clearest case in the benchmark of a government designating the land before the airport and then filling it in the order the ladder predicts.

The Dubai Government launched Dubai South in 2006 as a 145 km² master-planned city designed for 500,000 jobs. Al Maktoum International, at Dubai World Central (DWC), opened to cargo in 2010, to general aviation in 2011 and to passengers in 2013. Dubai Airports describes DWC as the heart of a 140 km² development of six clustered zones; the free zone offers 100% foreign ownership under a single authority.

Three links tie the site to the rest of Dubai. A bonded logistics corridor runs to Jebel Ali Port, about 14.5 km away. Expo City Dubai, 3.5 km² beside DWC, has its own metro station. The planned Airport Express Line will run 55 km with five stations between the two airports, and the Dubai Metro will grow from 90 km to 162 km by 2032.

The programme behind it is dated and funded: an AED 128 billion second phase for Al Maktoum International, five runways and a first phase opening in 2032, after which all operations at Dubai International are to move to DWC.

Inside the plan sit the districts set out in Exhibit 12: the Logistics District and EZDubai, the Mohammed Bin Rashid Aerospace Hub (MBRAH), the Business Park, the Residential District, the Golf District and Emaar South, Emaar's golf community of 22,700 planned homes.

145 km²
Dubai South master plan, launched in 2006

AED 128 bn
second phase of Al Maktoum International, about US$34.85 billion

55 km
Airport Express Line with five stations between DXB and DWC

DUBAI SOUTH DISTRICTS

Every rung of the ladder is now occupied at Dubai South, from bonded warehouses to golf villas

EXHIBIT 12

Dubai South, Emaar South and Expo City Dubai: nine components, each active in 2025 or 2026

Districts and major schemes of the Dubai South airport city, with published size and progress

COMPONENT	USES	SIZE AS PUBLISHED	PROGRESS, 2021 TO 2026	DEVELOPER
Logistics District and EZDubai	Logistics, e-commerce, free zone	EZDubai's first phase is half the district	Toll: 25,000 m², 30,644 pallets (2026); Dior regional centre, 7,200 m²; multi-user units of 215,278 sq ft for 2026	Dubai South
Mohammed Bin Rashid Aerospace Hub (MBRAH)	Business aviation, maintenance, aerospace	Complexes of 16,661 m² and 24,900 m²	20,289 business aviation movements in 2025 (+17%), a Dubai record; regional headquarters for up to 800 professionals; 88-unit supplier complex	Dubai South
Business Park	Offices	243,805 sq ft leased in 2021	About 700 companies attracted in 2022; 85% retained in 2021	Dubai South
Residential District	Homes and retail	The Pulse: 1,400 apartments, 240 townhouses	800 homes delivered in 2025; about 1,300 due in 2026; South Bay: 1,000+ homes and a 200,000 sq ft mall	Dubai South Properties
HAYAT by Dubai South	Homes and hotel apartments	10 million sq ft; about 2,500 homes	Sold out in 2025; AED 2 billion construction contract; first phases by 2028	Dubai South Properties
Golf District	Golf community and mixed use	2 km² golf community	Mixed-use project with a private developer	Dubai South with partners
Emaar South	Golf community and homes	22,700 homes, 53,000 m² of retail	18-hole golf course, 25 parks, 30 collections; homes from AED 1.06 million	Emaar Properties
Mixed-use master community	Homes, retail, offices	22 million sq ft	AED 62 billion development value; partnership signed in 2026	Majid Al Futtaim with Dubai South
Expo City Dubai	Legacy city and free zone	3.5 km², five districts	35,000+ residents and 40,000 professionals planned; metro station	Expo City Dubai

Source: Dubai Media Office (2022); Gulf News (2023); Dubai South (2025, 2026); Dubai South Properties (2025); Emaar Properties, Emaar South community page; Expo City Dubai, master plan brochure. District land areas are not published.

Company formation is the clearest sign of absorption. Dubai South welcomed 653 new companies in 2025, taking operating businesses above 4,200, with new licences up 65% and 90% of companies retained. Demand for the logistics district is underwritten by e-commerce: the UAE market reached AED 42.2 billion in 2025, up from AED 17.6 billion in 2020, and is forecast at about AED 67.2 billion by 2030, according to EZDubai's annual study with Euromonitor.

The logistics district fills with a mix of build-to-suit and multi-user space. Toll Group broke ground on a 25,000 m² facility with 30,644 pallet positions, Dior opened a 7,200 m² LEED Gold regional distribution centre with bonded access to Jebel Ali, and Dubai South launched about 215,278 sq ft of multi-user units in units of 2,152 and 3,767 sq ft.

Homes came after the jobs and are now the fastest-moving use. The Pulse, Dubai South Properties' first community, has 1,400 apartments and 240 townhouses, and its staff accommodation reported 99% occupancy. In 2025 three launches sold out completely, 800 homes were delivered and about 1,300 more are due in 2026.

653

new companies at Dubai South in 2025; more than 4,200 now operate

+65%

growth in new licences in 2025, with 90% retention

AED 42.2 bn

UAE e-commerce market in 2025, about US$11.5 billion

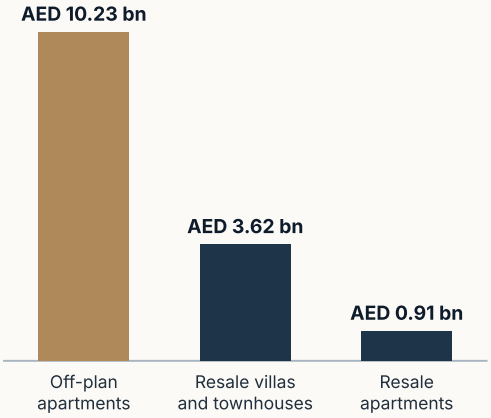
THE DUBAI SOUTH HOUSING MARKET

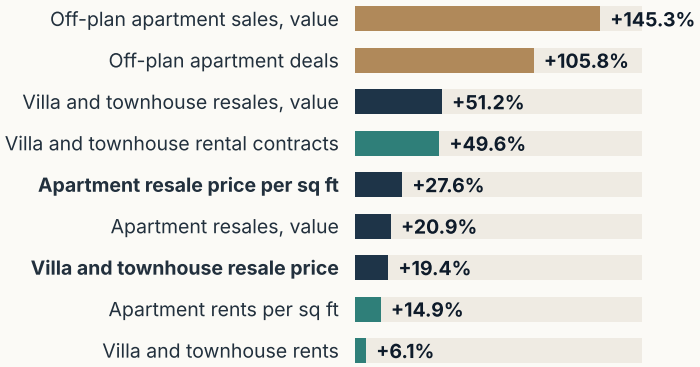
Buyers in Dubai South are pricing homes on the 2032 opening of the new terminal

EXHIBIT 13

Developers sold eleven times as much by value off plan as was resold, and resale prices rose 19 to 28%

Left: residential sales value in Dubai South, 2025 (AED billion). Right: change on 2024 (%)





Source: Metropolitan Premium Properties, Dubai South apartments and townhouses and villas 2025 resale reports, based on Property Monitor analysis of Dubai Land Department registrations (2026). The web page and report differ slightly (866 or 867 apartment resales; AED 914.8 million or 916 million); the web figures are shown. Off-plan villa and townhouse sales are omitted because their geographic scope is not stated. **Heirstone analysis** for the off-plan to resale ratio.

Dubai South's housing market is led by the developers. In 2025, 6,821 off-plan apartment sales worth AED 10.23 billion (about US$2.79 billion) were registered, against 866 apartment resales worth AED 914.8 million, about eleven to one by value. Resale prices rose 27.6% to an average AED 1,217 per sq ft (US$331), and townhouse and villa resales rose 19.4% to AED 1,263 per sq ft. Apartment rents rose 14.9% to AED 77 per sq ft, a 7.6% gross yield on 6,687 rental contracts.

Tenants confirm that the demand is real. Occupancy of Dubai South apartments rose from 87.6% in 2023 to 91.6% in 2024, according to Knight Frank citing REIDIN.

Property Finder added 32 new Dubai South developments in 2024, and the share of its users searching the area rose from 9% to 16%. Dubai's whole market recorded AED 686.8 billion of sales in 2025, with Dubai South among the most active areas by value.

The next phases are named and dated. Emaar South lists 22,700 homes, including 15,360 apartments, with prices from AED 1.06 million (about US$289,000). HAYAT by Dubai South will hold about 2,500 homes. In 2026 Dubai South and Majid Al Futtaim agreed to build an AED 62 billion (US$16.9 billion) master community of 22 million sq ft.

11 to 1

off-plan against resale apartment value in 2025 (Heirstone analysis)

7.6%

gross yield on Dubai South apartments in 2025

91.6%

apartment occupancy in 2024, up from 87.6% in 2023

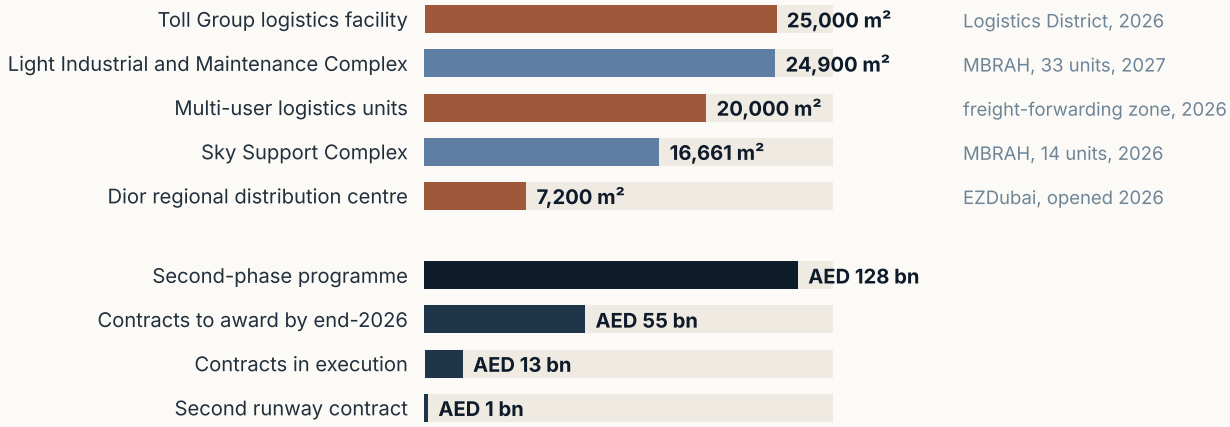
THE AVIATION DISTRICT AND THE NEW TERMINAL

The aviation district earns rent before the airlines move

EXHIBIT 14

Dubai South launched or delivered about 94,000 m² of logistics and aerospace space in 2025 and 2026, as the AED 128 billion terminal programme moved to contracts

Top: floor space launched, under construction or opened at Dubai South, 2025 to 2026 (m²) with district and completion year. Bottom: Al Maktoum International second-phase programme and contracts (AED billion)



Source: Dubai South (2025, 2026); Dubai Airports Media Centre, DWC fact file; The National (2026); AGBI (2026); Economy Middle East (2025). Multi-user units converted from 215,278 sq ft. **Heirstone analysis** for the total.

Business aviation and aerospace are filling the aviation district years before airline traffic moves. MBRAH recorded 20,289 business aviation movements in 2025, up 17% and the highest private jet activity Dubai has recorded. Avia Solutions Group, described by Dubai South as the world's largest ACMI provider, chose Dubai South for a regional headquarters for up to 800 professionals. A maintenance hangar opened in 2025 can take 12 narrow-body or five wide-body aircraft, and a supplier complex of 88 units completes at the end of 2026.

The terminal programme has moved from plan to site. Dubai approved the AED 128 billion second phase in 2024: five runways, four satellite concourses with more than 400 contact stands, 150 million passengers within ten years and 260 million ultimately. Contracts worth AED 13 billion were in execution in 2026, with more than AED 55 billion to be awarded by the end of the year; the site had logged 10 million work hours and 17,000 piles. An automated people mover is due in 2031, and Emirates has said it will invest US$10 to 12 billion at the airport.

20,289

business aviation movements at MBRAH in 2025, a Dubai record

2032

first phase of the new Al Maktoum International terminal

AED 55 bn

contracts to be awarded by the end of 2026, about US$15 billion

CHAPTER 4

04 King Salman International, Red Sea International and NEOM Bay Airport: airports planned with their land

Saudi Arabia is building three kinds of airport at once: a global hub in Riyadh, a destination airport sized to its resorts on the Red Sea, and NEOM's first gateway. In each, the airport and the land around it are planned together from the start.

King Salman International Airport (KSIA) in Riyadh has a 57 km² master plan by Foster + Partners with six runways and several terminals. PIF targets up to 120 million passengers a year by 2030, 185 million by 2050 and 3.5 million tonnes of cargo by 2050, with 103,000 direct and indirect jobs and SAR 27 billion (about US$7.2 billion) a year added to non-oil GDP. The master plan includes 12 km² of airport support facilities and a multi-asset real estate area of residential, recreational, retail and logistics uses, and the development company counts real estate and cargo buildings among its eight assets.

57 km²

KSIA master plan, with six runways

21%

of the site set aside as a support-facility zone (Heirstone analysis)

EXHIBIT 15

King Salman International counts real estate and cargo among its eight assets, and two of them went to contract in 2026

The eight assets of the KSIA development programme and their published status

ASSET	WHAT IT ADDS	STATUS, 2025 TO 2026
Iconic Terminal	Passenger terminal	Master plan and design by Foster + Partners
Terminal 6	Adds 40 million passengers of capacity	Enabling and substructure works awarded in 2026; due before Expo 2030 Riyadh
Private aviation terminal	Business and private aviation	Awarded in 2026 for SAR 800 million (about US$214 million)
Central runway and temporary apron	Airfield	Design-and-build offers for the third runway submitted in 2025
Hangars	Maintenance and aviation business	In the programme
Landside transport	Roads and links to the city	In the programme
Cargo buildings	Air cargo, 3.5 million t a year by 2050	In the programme
Real estate	Residential, recreational, retail and logistics real estate inside the 57 km² plan, beside 12 km² of support facilities	In the master plan since 2022

Source: MEED (2025, 2026); SteelOrbis (2026); Saudi Press Agency (2024); The Moodie Davitt Report, reporting PIF (2022). SAR converted at the 3.75 peg; the US$ figure is as published.

KSIA keeps its land inside the airport boundary. Its 12 km² support zone is about 21% of the 57 km² site, and the real estate area sits within the same plan, against roughly two hectares of city for every hectare of airport at Dubai South. That makes its real estate scarce and concentrated beside a 185-million-passenger plan, the condition in which, in the US rent evidence, airport land earns its highest premium. It suits gateway-district densities and a release programme timed with Terminal 6 and Expo 2030 Riyadh.

The private aviation terminal, awarded in 2026, repeats Dubai's lesson that aviation business can earn before the main terminal opens. The national programme gives the hub its scale: Saudi Arabia plans to invest US$100 billion in aviation, and its aviation strategy targets 330 million passengers, 4.5 million tonnes of cargo and more than 250 destinations by 2030.

RED SEA INTERNATIONAL, NEOM BAY, DOHA AND ABU DHABI

On the Red Sea, the airport is sized to the destination

EXHIBIT 16

Red Sea International and NEOM Bay Airport opened as the first assets of their destinations; Doha and Abu Dhabi show the hub and gateway models

Airports, the land programmes around them and their published status

AIRPORT AND DISTRICT	OPENED	AIRPORT OR LAND	WHAT THE LAND HOLDS	STATUS, 2024 TO 2026
Red Sea International (RSI)	2023	3,700 m runway for Code F aircraft; designed for 1 million visitors a year (2 million passenger movements)	The Red Sea: 28,000 km² with 90+ islands, 18 hotels with about 3,000 keys and 1,000+ homes; visitors capped at 1 million a year. AMAALA: 9 hotels, about 1,600 keys, 300+ branded residences	70 flights a week; first Saudi airport rated LEED Platinum (2024)
NEOM Bay Airport	2019	Single 3,757 m runway	Gateway to NEOM's regions; NEOM's first operational asset, ahead of the Port of NEOM (2022)	Scheduled Riyadh flights from 2019; weekly Dubai service from 2022
Hamad International: Airport City	2014	10 km² over a 30-year master plan	Business District, Aviation Campus, Logistics District and Residential District on a green spine, for 200,000 people living and working	Master plan published in 2013
Zayed International: Masdar City	n/a	Masdar City is five minutes from the airport	Masdar City Square: seven commercial buildings, 50,000 m² GFA; buildings use 40% less energy and water than comparable ones	Record 32.5 million passengers and 770,000 t of cargo (+12%) at Abu Dhabi's airports in 2025
Abu Dhabi: KEZAD (port-led)	n/a	550+ km², 100 km² of it free zone, in 12 zones	2,300+ clients, 164,000+ jobs, 73.6 km² leased, 540,000+ m² of warehousing	Revenue AED 2.87 billion and EBITDA AED 1.56 billion in 2025

Source: Red Sea Global (2025, 2026); Gulf News, quoting Red Sea Global (2025); NEOM; ch-aviation (2019); Arab News (2022); Gulf Times (2013); Middle East Construction News (2013); Qatar Airways (2014); Masdar City, homepage and location page; Abu Dhabi Airports (2026); KEZAD Group.

Red Sea International Airport began operations in 2023 and is designed for 1 million visitors a year, or 2 million passenger movements, the same number as the destination's cap of 1 million visitors. Its 3,700 m runway takes Code F aircraft including the A380; Saudia, flydubai and flynas serve it, its first international flights came from Dubai in 2024, and Red Sea Global has held talks with more than 60 airlines. In 2024 it became the first Saudi airport rated LEED Platinum.

Setting airport capacity equal to the visitor cap is rare in the benchmark, and it matters for land. Every hotel key the destination builds can be served, and supply cannot outrun the cap, which supports room rates and the value of the hotel land. AMAALA, with 9 hotels and about 1,600 keys, opens its first phase in 2026 and secured a SAR 6.5 billion green loan in 2025.

NEOM Bay Airport became operational in 2019 as NEOM's first operational asset, three years before the Port of NEOM, with a 3,757 m runway and scheduled flights from Riyadh; a weekly service to Dubai followed in 2022. Doha planned a 10 km² Airport City for 200,000 people around Hamad International in 2013, a year before the airport opened. In Abu Dhabi, Masdar City is five minutes from Zayed International, where passengers reached a record 32.5 million in 2025.

1 million

visitors a year: RSI's design capacity and The Red Sea's visitor cap

2019

NEOM Bay Airport, NEOM's first operational asset

32.5M

passengers at Zayed International in 2025, a record



CHAPTER 5

05

From Sphinx International Airport to the Grand Egyptian Museum

Egypt has built a destination airport for the Giza pyramids and the museum beside them, and a capital airport for its new seat of government. The two were inaugurated together in 2020, and both are drawing the land investment the benchmark predicts.

Sphinx International Airport sits at km 45 of the Cairo-Alexandria Desert Road and was designed to serve Giza and the Grand Egyptian Museum (GEM). Trial operations began in 2018 and regular flights in 2019; it was built for about EGP 300 million. An expansion took the terminal to about 24,000 m^2 with 26 check-in counters and nine aircraft stands, and lifted capacity from 900,000 to 1.2 million passengers a year, with a stated target of 5 million within five years.

Traffic has followed. Twenty-two airlines now fly to 25 destinations, among them easyJet, Wizz Air, flydubai, Flynas and Condor. Sphinx passed one million passengers in 2025 with two months of the year still to run, 21% ahead of a year earlier, and averaged 95 weekly flights in the 2024/25 winter, up 27%. The Egyptian Airports Company reports that demand rose 30 to 35% after the museum opened, with day trips flown in from Sharm El-Sheikh, Hurghada and Marsa Matrouh; easyJet added Paris in 2026.

The museum is the anchor. The GEM was officially opened in 2025 on a 490,000 m^2 site with 167,000 m^2 of buildings and about 100,000 artefacts. It received about 4 million visitors in its first ten months, an annual pace of about 4.85 million (Heirstone analysis), in line with the government's expectation of about 5 million a year; 60% were foreign. On the Giza Plateau, visitor services run under a public-private partnership that shares revenue equally with the state and expects EGP 3 to 3.5 billion of revenue by the end of 2026.

1.2M
passengers a year of capacity at Sphinx; 5 million targeted

4M
GEM visitors in its first ten months, 60% foreign

30 to 35%
rise in demand at Sphinx after the GEM opened, according to the Egyptian Airports Company

GREATER CAIRO

Three airports, three land stories across Greater Cairo

EXHIBIT 17

Sphinx International serves the museum and West Cairo; Capital International serves the New Administrative Capital

Airports, the Grand Egyptian Museum, the Giza pyramids and new cities of Greater Cairo, with straight-line distances and plan areas drawn as circles of equal area



Source: GeoNames records: Sphinx International 11203813, Grand Egyptian Museum 8556337, Giza pyramids 355017, Sheikh Zayed City 7802749, 6th of October City 7577132, Cairo International 6297293, New Administrative Capital 12188760. Capital International is placed at its published aerodrome reference point (ACUKWIK airport directory). Downtown Cairo is approximate. Plan areas from the Presidency of Egypt (170,000 feddans) and Asharq Al-Awsat (2019; 59,400 feddans); circles are centred on the published points and are schematic. Distances are Heirstone calculations.

Each of Greater Cairo's airports anchors a different rung of the ladder. At Cairo International, logistics lead: Terminal 4, planned for about 40 million passengers, will take the airport to roughly 70 million, and a cargo city alongside starts at 1 million tonnes a year, expandable to 2 million. Sphinx International leads with hotels, built around the museum. Capital International was built with the New Administrative Capital and serves the city first.

Sphinx sits 25.1 km in a straight line from the GEM, about 35 minutes by road according to the Egyptian Airports Company, and 11.4 km from Sheikh Zayed City. The museum stands 2.2 km from the pyramids. Capital International lies about 9 km from the New Administrative Capital's centre point and 42 km from Cairo International. Around Sphinx, New Sphinx City was enlarged from 31,953 to 59,400 feddans, about 250 km², with residential and commercial sectors and the airport within it.

The corridor follows the Cairo-Alexandria Desert Road. Sphinx International sits at km 45 and TBK's new project at km 47, opposite the airport. In the east, the LRT and the East Nile Monorail tie the New Administrative Capital to Cairo, so Capital International serves a city with two rail links already in service.

25.1 km

from Sphinx International to the Grand Egyptian Museum, about 35 minutes by road

59,400

feddans in New Sphinx City, about 250 km²

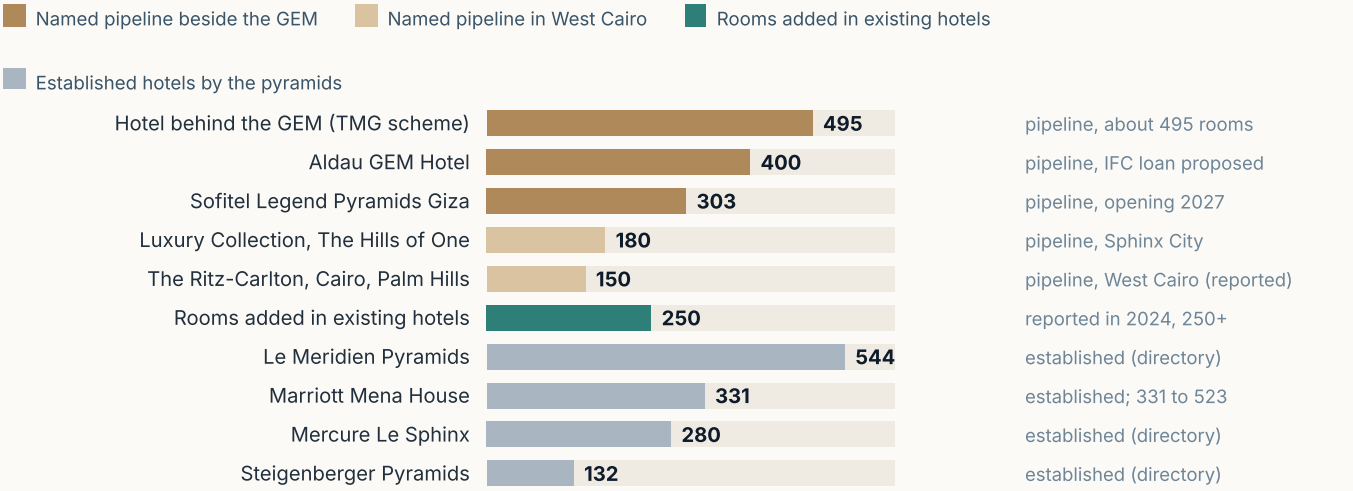
HOTELS AT THE GRAND EGYPTIAN MUSEUM

About 1,200 hotel keys are planned within sight of the museum

EXHIBIT 18

Three named schemes add about 1,200 keys beside the GEM, on the scale of the four established hotels by the pyramids

Hotel rooms and keys in the pipeline and in operation around the Grand Egyptian Museum, the pyramids and West Cairo



Source: Accor via Hospitality Net (2024); Egyptian Streets (2025); Zawya (TMG disclosure); IFC disclosures, project 52177 (2026); Marriott via Journal des Palaces (2026); CairoScene (2023) for The Ritz-Carlton; Egypt Telegraph and Asharq Al-Awsat (2024). Established hotels: room counts for Le Meridien, Mercure and Steigenberger as listed in the Business Travel News hotel directory; for Mena House, Business Traveller (2018) gives 331 rooms and the same directory 523, and the chart shows 331. **Heirstone analysis** for totals: 1,198 named keys beside the GEM, 1,528 including West Cairo, against 1,287 to 1,479 in the four established hotels.

The land beside the museum is being valued for hotels first, as the destination rung of the ladder predicts. In 2024 the Cabinet stressed the need for international hotels around the GEM and for using Sphinx to bring visitors to Giza. Three schemes alone add about 1,200 keys. Accor and Abu Dhabi's ADTIC signed the 303-room Sofitel Legend Pyramids Giza, 500 metres from the museum, for 2027; reported at US$120 million with Abu Dhabi Fund for Development finance covering 84.28%, it works out at about US$397,000 per key. IFC has disclosed a proposed loan of up to US$100 million for the 400-key Aldau GEM Hotel, in a package of up to US$265 million with other lenders including EBRD.

Behind the museum, TMG Holding and NUCA have begun a US$788 million scheme on 42.4 feddans: a five-star hotel of about 495 rooms, a residential hotel, serviced residences, retail, offices and entertainment. TMG expects more than US$82 million a year of recurring net income, about 10.4% on the total investment (Heirstone analysis), plus about US$233 million of net real estate sales. A Banque Misr subsidiary with Saudi and Kuwaiti investors plans an EGP 3 billion hotel directly across from the GEM for 2028, according to a travel trade report. Established operators are adding rooms too: one told the Cabinet it had opened more than 250 new rooms in its existing hotels.

The national target puts these keys in context. Egypt plans to add roughly 250,000 hotel keys to reach 30 million tourists by 2030.

1,198

named pipeline keys beside the GEM; 1,528 with West Cairo (Heirstone analysis)

10.4%

recurring return on cost expected from TMG's GEM scheme (Heirstone analysis)

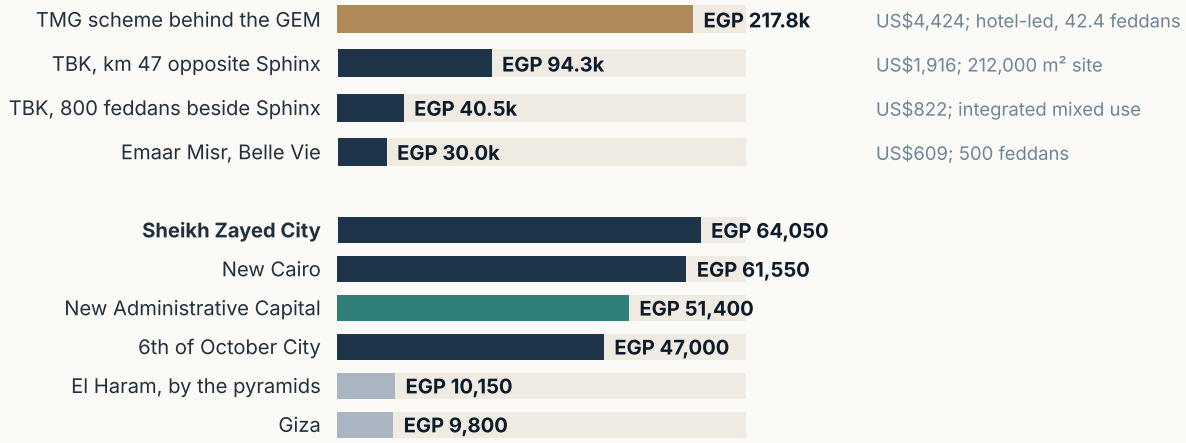
THE SPHINX CORRIDOR AND WEST CAIRO

Master developers have taken the corridor between Sheikh Zayed and Sphinx International Airport

EXHIBIT 19

Planned investment per square metre of land rises towards the museum, and apartments in the master-planned cities are listed at 4.6 to 6.3 times El Haram

Top: planned investment per m² of land, EGP thousand, with US$ at the 2025 average of EGP 49.23 per US$. Bottom: average apartment asking prices on Aqarmap listings, end-2025 (EGP per m²)



Source: Zawya (TMG disclosure); Daily News Egypt (2025); Invest-Gate (2026); Global Property Guide, Egypt price history (2025), based on Aqarmap data; World Bank official exchange rate (2025). Planned investment is the developer's stated project value divided by land area, not a land price; the TMG scheme is converted to EGP at the 2025 average. **Heirstone analysis.**

Egypt created New Sphinx City by decree in 2018 and later enlarged it to 59,400 feddans. The large parcels went to master developers. TBK Developments acquired 800 feddans adjacent to Sphinx International for an EGP 136 billion scheme (about US$2.8 billion) master-planned by HHCP, and is building a project opposite the airport at km 47 with 192 villas and 300 apartments. Emaar Misr's Belle Vie, its second West Cairo community, spans 500 feddans in Sheikh Zayed with about EGP 63 billion of investment; deliveries begin in 2026 and an American International School campus opens in 2027. SODIC's 464-acre New Zayed, near the airport and planned for more than 5,000 homes, raised an EGP 4.14 billion syndicated loan from Banque Misr and CIB.

Investment intensity rises towards the museum. TMG's hotel-led scheme carries about US$4,424 of planned investment per m² of land, about five times TBK's 800-feddan parcel. The new cities also command a clear premium: average asking prices for Sheikh Zayed apartments were EGP 64,050 per m² at the end of 2025, 6.3 times those in the El Haram district by the pyramids. 6th of October City's industrial space was 95% occupied in the first half of 2025, with prime rents of up to US$8 per m² a month, the highest in Cairo, according to Knight Frank.

EGP 136 bn

TBK's scheme on 800 feddans beside Sphinx International

6.3x

Sheikh Zayed apartment asking prices against El Haram (Heirstone analysis)

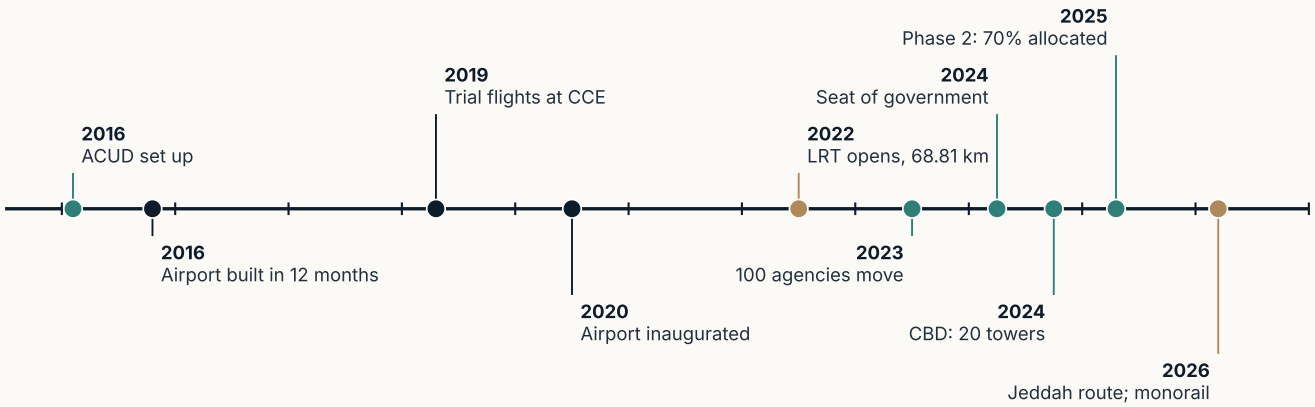


The New Administrative Capital and Capital International Airport

EXHIBIT 20

The New Administrative Capital followed the capital-airport sequence: land, airport, rail, government, then the international route

Milestones of the New Administrative Capital and Capital International Airport (CCE)



Source: El Watan News (2016, 2022); Airport Technology (2019); Invest-Gate (2020, 2025); Cairo Governorate (2022, 2023); Al-Ahram Weekly (2024); Ministry of Housing (2024); Amwal Al Ghad and Bloomberg (2026); Egyptian Streets (2026).

The New Administrative Capital is the benchmark's largest capital-airport city and its clearest state master-developer model. The Presidency describes a first phase of 40,000 feddans within 170,000, about 714 km^2. ACUD, set up in 2016 as master developer and part-owned by NUCA, holds a 220,000-feddan portfolio and expected land sales to return about EGP 300 billion. More than 400 developers run more than 500 projects; coverage is capped at 25% on residential plots and 40% on commercial ones. ACUD reported EGP 19.8 billion of pre-tax profit for 2022 on assets of EGP 255 billion, and opened Phase 2 in 2025 with 70% of its land allocated.

Government and finance have moved in. By 2023, 100 agencies including 30 ministries and 40,000 employees had relocated, and the presidential swearing-in of 2024 marked the city as the seat of government. The Central Business District has 20 towers, among them 806,000 m^2 of offices and 1,700 finished homes, and the Iconic Tower, at 393.8 m Egypt's tallest building. Residents doubled from more than 15,000 in early 2025 to almost 30,000 in 2026, served by 14 schools and six universities.

Transit came before the crowds. The LRT from Adly Mansour opened in 2022 with 68.81 km and 12 stations, designed for 500,000 passengers a day, and the 56.5 km East Nile Monorail opened in 2026 with capacity for up to 500,000 a day. Capital International, built in 12 months with a 3,650 m runway, opened its first regular international route in 2026: Air Cairo to Jeddah six times a week.

400+

developers active in the New Administrative Capital

2x

residents from early 2025 to 2026, to almost 30,000

500,000

passengers a day: design capacity of each rail link

EGYPT'S AIRPORT-LAND MODELS

Egypt's airport-land precedents run from Marsa Alam to the New Administrative Capital

EXHIBIT 21

Egypt runs or is building four airport-land models, and a national framework now links them

Airport-land models in Egypt, with what is in place and what each offers investors

MODEL	WHERE	WHAT IS IN PLACE	WHAT IT OFFERS INVESTORS
Airport concession with a land bank	Marsa Alam International and Port Ghalib	Egypt's first private build-operate-transfer airport, a 40-year concession won in 1997 and opened in 2001; the same sponsor took 22 million m² along 20 km of coast for a scheme of more than US$1 billion with a 1,000-berth marina, 5 km away	Bundle a concession with a defined land bank
Destination airport with a new city	Sphinx International, the GEM and New Sphinx City	NUCA new city of 59,400 feddans; corridor parcels taken by TBK, Emaar Misr and SODIC; about 1,200 named hotel keys beside the museum	Hotel-first land release near the attraction
Capital airport with a state master developer	Capital International and the New Administrative Capital	ACUD holds 220,000 feddans and sells to more than 400 developers; LRT and monorail in service; first international route in 2026	Phased land sales funding the city's infrastructure
Cargo city at the hub	Cairo International Terminal 4	Terminal 4 for about 40 million passengers; cargo city of 1 million t a year, expandable to 2 million	Logistics-first land beside the main hub
National framework	IFC programme and the 2026 directive	Eleven airports including Sphinx in an IFC-advised PPP programme, with ownership retained; Hurghada pilot with seven consortia prequalified; 2026 directive on integrated investment zones around airports	Airport partnerships with investment zones attached

Source: Al Bawaba (2001); MEED (2000); Asharq Al-Awsat (2019); Daily News Egypt (2025); Invest-Gate (2026); Bnok24 (2024); El Watan News (2022); Al-Ahram Gate (2024); Ahram Online (2026); Egyptian State Information Service (2025); IFC (2025); Zawya (2026). Port Ghalib's distance from the airport is a Heirstone calculation from GeoNames points.

Egypt has expanded its airport system quickly. The Cabinet lists four new airports since 2014, taking the country from 19 to 23: Sphinx International, Capital International, Berenice International and Al Bardawil International. Capacity rose from 7.5 to 13 million passengers a year at Hurghada and from 7 to 10 million at Sharm El-Sheikh, and Borg El Arab's 40,000 m² second terminal, with a 10,000-tonne cargo terminal, took Alexandria to 6 million. On the North Coast, El Alamein International handled 266,600 passengers in the first seven months of 2026, 57% more than a year earlier, with 15 airlines.

Two policy steps now connect the airports to land. Egypt engaged IFC in 2025 to introduce public-private partnerships at 11 airports, Sphinx among them, with ownership staying with the state holding company and bundling under study; for the Hurghada pilot, ten consortia applied and seven were prequalified in 2026. In 2026 the President directed that integrated investment zones be created around Egyptian airports to attract foreign direct investment, with the airports remaining state-owned.

Together these give Egypt the means to tender an airport partnership with a defined investment zone attached, using a model it has already run at Marsa Alam and Port Ghalib. Sphinx is the natural first case, with New Sphinx City's 59,400 feddans, the hotel demand around the GEM and a stated target of 5 million passengers.

23

airports in Egypt, up from 19 in 2014

11

airports in the IFC-advised partnership programme, Sphinx among them

22M m²

at Port Ghalib, held by the sponsor of Marsa Alam International

CHAPTER 6

Bishoftu, Bugesera, Lekki-Epe, Blaise Diagne and New Tashkent: land designated at year zero

06

Most of the new airports in Africa and Central Asia are paired with a fiscal zone or a new city from the start, so their governments can price and phase the uplift themselves.

EXHIBIT 22

Eight programmes in Africa and Central Asia pair an airport with a designated zone or city

Airport-linked zones and cities in Africa and Central Asia: area, location, model, terms and status

ZONE OR SITE	COUNTRY	AREA (HA)	LOCATION	DEVELOPER AND MODEL	TERMS OR USES	STATUS, 2025 TO 2026
Bishoftu airport and Airport City	Ethiopia	3,500	About 40 km from Bole	Ethiopian Airlines Group; plot in eight lots, about ETB 30 billion (US$233 million) of site preparation	Airport city of commercial, hospitality and community uses designed with the airport; 350-room hotel in the terminal complex	Ground broken in 2026; phase one for 60 million passengers
Bugesera Special Economic Zone	Rwanda	336	56 km from Kigali	Public-private partnership of Arise IIP and the Government of Rwanda, US$100 million	100% corporate tax exemption (conditions apply); property tax and customs exemptions; zero-rated VAT	Operating; new airport for 8 million passengers due in 2027 to 2028
Lekki Free Trade Zone and Lekki-Epe airport site	Nigeria	16,500 and 3,500	About 10 km apart	Free-zone company; Lagos State PPP for the airport (agreement with a developer, 2025)	Free-zone regime; airport planned for Code F aircraft	110 ha sold to 16 investors in 2025; airport proposed
Integrated Special Economic Zone (ZESID)	Senegal	718	Adjoins Blaise Diagne; 45 km from Dakar	State zone created by decree in 2017	15% corporate tax, 3% on local sales, other duties exempt for 25 years; 60% of turnover exported	Operating since the airport's opening year
Diamniadio urban pole and P2ID	Senegal	1,644 and 53	About 30 km from Dakar	State agencies	About fifteen ministries due to move; P2ID industrial park	P2ID: 11 firms and 557 jobs (2021)
JKIA Airport City and SEZ	Kenya	Within 4,452	Nairobi	Kenya Airports Authority	Land safeguarded for a third runway, terminals, an airport city and an SEZ	Reserved in the 2026 master plan
Luanda airport city	Angola	n/p	About 40 km south-east of Luanda	State airport; private operator; master plan by Foster + Partners	Logistics centre as the first phase	Airport opened 2023; logistics centre scheduled from 2026
New Tashkent	Uzbekistan	19,720 (airport 1,310)	Shares the Urtachirchiq district with the airport	State directorate; terminal PPP with a 35-year term	On-site high-speed rail station at the airport	City under construction since 2023; airport due 2029 to 2030

Source: US International Trade Administration (2025); The Reporter Ethiopia (2025); Dar Al-Handasah (2026); AllAfrica (2026); AfDB (2025); Bugesera SEZ and Arise IIP; The New Times (2024, 2025); Federal Ministry of Information, Nigeria (2025); Estate Intel (2026); APIX (2021); Au Senegal (2018); Kenya Airports Authority (2026); Aviation Week (2025); China Daily (2023); President of Uzbekistan press service (2023); Interfax and Kun.uz (2026). US$ conversions at US Treasury rates (ETB 128.88). n/p: not published.

Ethiopia's Bishoftu is the largest airport in the group. Its 35 km^2 site, about 40 km from Bole, holds the airport and an airport city of commercial, hospitality and community uses designed together by a consortium led by Dar Al-Handasah. Ground was broken in 2026; phase one has two parallel runways for 60 million passengers, rising to 110 million.

AfDB has set out to mobilise nearly US$8 billion of the US$10 billion the project needs. Rwanda's Bugesera Special Economic Zone, 335.67 ha, is operating before the new airport it serves.

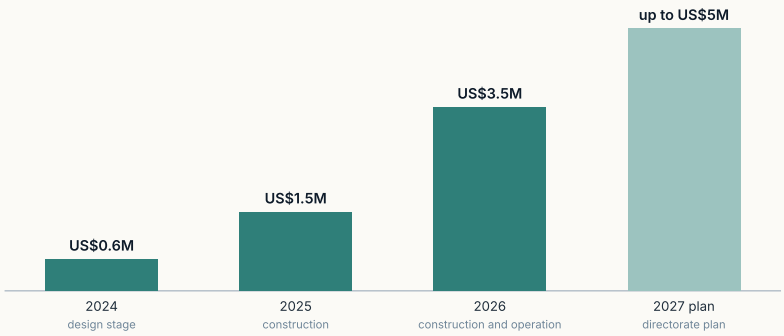
NEW TASHKENT

New Tashkent shows how fast designated land can be revalued, years before the airport opens

EXHIBIT 23

On its directorate's figures, the investment potential of New Tashkent's land rose almost sixfold in two years

Investment potential of land per hectare in New Tashkent, as reported by the city's directorate, 2024 to 2026 and the 2027 plan (US$ million per ha)



Source: Directorate for the Construction of New Tashkent (2026), which presents these figures as the investment potential of land; the 2027 figure is its plan, given as a range from US$0.6 million to US$5 million. **Heirstone analysis** for the multiple.

5.8x

investment potential of New Tashkent's land, 2026 against 2024 (Heirstone analysis)

19,720 ha

allocated to New Tashkent in 2023

15.1x

city land to airport land at New Tashkent (Heirstone analysis)

Uzbekistan allocated 19,720 ha to New Tashkent in 2023 in the Yuqorichirchiq and Urtachirchiq districts. The new airport's 1,310 ha site lies in the Urtachirchiq and Quyichirchiq districts, so city and airport share a district, with about 15 hectares of city for every hectare of airport. The airport is planned with two 4 km runways, a 208,000 m^2 terminal and 98 stands for 20 million passengers a year from the end of 2030, growing to 46 million. A consortium of Vision Invest (45%), Sojitz (30%), Incheon International Airport Corporation (15%) and Uzbekistan Airports (10%) will build and run the terminal for 35 years, and the airport will have its own high-speed rail station, with links to the main toll roads and shuttles to the capital.

The directorate puts the investment potential of land at US$0.6 million a hectare in 2024, US$1.5 million in 2025 and US$3.5 million in 2026, and plans for up to US$5 million in 2027, which it describes as a roughly eightfold rise in the capitalisation of land. Officials put the first stage at 6,000 ha with planned facilities worth US$50 billion.

On the directorate's own measure, land in New Tashkent was revalued on the programme: the city decree, the airport plan and the rail link, before the airport's first flight. Because one state directorate holds the land, the uplift accrues to the programme that created it. African programmes that hold their zones, such as Bishoftu's eight lots, ZESID and the JKIA reservation, are in the same position.

The same holds across West and East Africa. Senegal decreed its 718 ha zone in the year Blaise Diagne International Airport opened and is building the Diamniadio urban pole between the airport and Dakar. Lagos plans the Lekki-Epe International Airport on 3,500 ha about 10 km from the 16,500 ha Lekki Free Trade Zone, where 110 ha were sold to 16 investors in 2025. Kenya's 2026 JKIA master plan safeguards land for an airport city and an SEZ, and Luanda's airport city starts with a logistics centre.

CHAPTER 7

07 Designate, phase, price, hold, link

The runway dividend is decided before most of it is earned: in the decree that designates the land, the order of release, the contour map and the rail link.

FOR

Governments and land agencies

1 Designate airport-city land in the same decision as the airport, as Dubai did with Dubai South in 2006 and Senegal with ZESID in 2017, and write the 55 and 65 dB contours of the final airport layout into the zoning before the first plot is sold.

2 Release land rung by rung, in tranches sized to demand. Schiphol's area developer sold 11 ha of a logistics park of more than 50 ha in 2017 and kept land in hand; near US airports, scarce industrial land earns a premium of 13% on average.

3 Build the rail link before the homes. Gateway Gardens' station is two minutes from Terminal 1; the New Administrative Capital's LRT and monorail each carry up to 500,000 passengers a day.

FOR

Airport owners and concession grantors

1 Keep the land closest to the terminal and lease it. Schiphol earns 8.5% of its revenue from rents; Changi kept 51% of Jewel.

2 Attach a defined land bank to airport partnerships where demand is destination-led. Egypt's 2026 directive and the Marsa Alam precedent make Sphinx the natural first case.

3 Lease aviation-business land from the first phase, as MBRAH at Dubai South and the KSIA private aviation terminal do.

FOR

Master developers

1 Underwrite the programme and the station: the dated opening, the rail link and the contour, as buyers at Dubai South already do.

2 Lead with hotels where the attraction exists. Beside the GEM, hotel-led land carries about five times the planned investment per m² of a mixed-use corridor parcel.

3 Match density to the rung: plot ratios of 1.4 to 3.9 in gateway districts, lower densities for homes beyond the contours.

FOR

Investors and lenders

1 Price industrial land on scarcity, not hub size: the US premium runs from 47.1% at O'Hare to 0.3% at Memphis.

2 Discount homes 0.5 to 1% per decibel inside the contours, and do not apply the same discount to land that can be zoned for logistics.

3 Read the off-plan to resale ratio and resale price growth as the market's verdict on a programme; in Dubai South both were strong in 2025.

FOR

Hotel and logistics operators

1 Secure sites at the destination early: the GEM pipeline of about 1,200 named keys and AMAALA's 1,600 keys show where operators are committing.

2 Take bonded multi-user space in the first phase; Dubai South offers units from 2,152 sq ft.

3 Size logistics on e-commerce demand: the UAE market is forecast to grow from AED 42.2 billion in 2025 to about AED 67.2 billion by 2030.

BY STAGE

Five decisions, each with a benchmark and an opportunity in the Gulf and Egypt

STAGE 1 Designate

Before the airport opens

DECISION

Zone the airport-city land with the airport; map contours for the final layout

BENCHMARK

Dubai South 4 years before opening; ZESID in the opening year; New Tashkent about 6 years before

OPPORTUNITY

Egypt: investment zones at Sphinx and Capital International under the 2026 directive

STAGE 2 Phase

First ten years

DECISION

Release by rung: cargo, aviation business, then gateway and destination uses, then homes

BENCHMARK

Dubai South: cargo 2010, residents by 2021, mass housing 2025 to 2026

OPPORTUNITY

Saudi Arabia: time KSIA's 12 km² with Terminal 6 and Expo 2030 Riyadh

STAGE 3 Price

At each release

DECISION

Price by contour, distance to the terminal and station

BENCHMARK

0.5 to 1% per dB for homes; 0.16% for land; 13% average industrial premium

OPPORTUNITY

UAE: price station-area plots on the 55 km Airport Express Line

STAGE 4 Hold or sell

For each parcel

DECISION

Hold and lease terminal-front land; sell where a partner brings an anchor

BENCHMARK

Schiphol rents 8.5% of revenue; Changi 51% of Jewel; Incheon 50-year lease

OPPORTUNITY

Egypt: NUCA partnerships at the GEM hotel zone; KSIA's real estate asset

STAGE 5 Link

Before the homes

DECISION

Fund rail to the terminal, the gateway district and the city

BENCHMARK

Gateway Gardens 2 minutes to Terminal 1; LRT and monorail at the New Administrative Capital

OPPORTUNITY

UAE: Airport Express Line and Metro to 162 km by 2032

BEFORE BUYING OR RELEASING A PARCEL: EIGHT NUMBERS TO CHECK

1 **Noise band**
The parcel's DNL or Lden band in the final airport layout: homes belong below 65 DNL, and Schiphol prices fall from 45 dB.

2 **Rail minutes**
Minutes by rail to the terminal and the city: Gateway Gardens is 2 minutes from Terminal 1 and 10 from Frankfurt's central station.

3 **Next airport phase**
The year of the next phase: 2032 for the new Al Maktoum International; before Expo 2030 Riyadh for KSIA's Terminal 6.

4 **Absorption below**
How much of the rung below is taken up: Schiphol's area developer sold 11 ha of a logistics park of more than 50 ha in one year.

5 **Density allowed**
Plot ratio against the benchmark: 1.4 to 3.9 in gateway districts; coverage caps of 25% for homes and 40% for commercial plots in the New Administrative Capital.

6 **Market depth**
Off-plan to resale value and resale price growth: 11 to 1 and +27.6% for Dubai South apartments in 2025.

7 **Fiscal status**
Free-zone or zone terms: 100% foreign ownership in the Dubai South free zone; 15% corporate tax for 25 years in Senegal's zones.

8 **The neighbour**
Who holds the land next door and how it releases it: a state master developer, the airport company or a concessionaire.

> *An airport creates the value once. The owner of the land decides whether it is collected once, at the first sale, or at every phase that follows.*

How Heirstone works on airport cities

We help governments, land agencies, airport owners, developers and investors decide what to build around an airport, when and at what value: demand studies by use, highest-and-best-use and land strategy, phasing and release programmes, feasibility and business models (DCF, IRR, NPV and Monte Carlo testing), and destination and hotel studies.

Get in touch

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NOTES, SOURCES AND DEFINITIONS

Notes

Definitions

Airport city: land planned or developed for non-aviation uses because of its relation to an airport, on or off the airport site. **Airport-city milestone:** the first year in which airport-city land was designated, launched or opened to a non-aviation use; **years from opening** is that year minus the airport's opening year, negative when the land came first. **Plan area:** land area as published by the owner or government. **City to airport land:** plan area divided by airport land. **Plot ratio:** gross floor area divided by site area. **DNL, Lden:** day-night and day-evening-night average sound levels; a **noise depreciation index** is the % change in price per decibel. **Feddan:** 4,200.83 m^2. **Off-plan:** sales by developers before completion.

Method

The Heirstone Airport Cities Benchmark 2026 combines public data from governments, master developers, airport operators, development finance institutions, academic studies and attributed market sources for 32 airport cities and airport-linked districts. Derived figures (jobs per hectare, plot ratio, city to airport land, years from opening, investment per m^2 of land, price ratios, keys in pipeline, off-plan to resale value) are labelled Heirstone analysis and use only the published inputs shown. Distances are straight-line calculations from GeoNames points. Currency conversions: AED 3.6725 and SAR 3.75 per US$ (official pegs); EGP 49.23 per US$ (World Bank 2025 average) unless the source gives its own conversion; EUR at US$1.13 (Eurostat 2025 average). Where sources conflict we give the range or the more conservative figure and say so; single-source figures with a lower grade in our register are attributed in the text. The five airport-city models and the Runway Ladder are Heirstone frameworks.

Use of this report

This report is published for general information. It is not investment, legal, planning or valuation advice and should not be relied on as such. Figures are as published by the sources named and current in 2026. © Heirstone Consulting L.L.C-FZ, 2026. Images are illustrative.

1 THE ORDER OF USES

FedEx, history; Changi Airport Group; NTU Business School and AFP (2019); Moodie Davitt Report (2013); SADC (2017, 2018, 2019); Airport Authority Hong Kong (2018, 2020); Architizer; Incheon International Airport Corporation; Incheon Free Economic Zone Authority; Korea Times (2016, 2023); TTG Asia (2023); GGB Magazine (2015); Sega Sammy (2017); Gateway Gardens (2019, 2024); Immobilien Zeitung; Memphis-Shelby County Airport Authority and InterVISTAS (2026); APIX (2021); Asharq Al-Awsat (2019); President of Uzbekistan press service (2023); Aviation Week (2025).

2 WHERE THE VALUE LANDS

ICAO, Balanced Approach; US eCFR, 14 CFR Part 150; EUR-Lex, Directive 2002/49/EC; Journal of Transport Economics and Policy (2004); GRA Inc. (2006); Asian Geographer (2013); Tinbergen Institute TI 2008-064/3; Journal of Urban Economics (2011); Swiss Journal of Economics and Statistics (2008); Federal Reserve Bank of St. Louis WP 2006-026C; Georgia Tech seminar paper on Richmond, BC (2015); CBRE via AJOT (2021); ACI EUROPE and InterVISTAS (2015); Royal Schiphol Group (2026); KEZAD Group; Eurostat (2025 exchange rate).

3 DUBAI SOUTH AND AL MAKTOUM INTERNATIONAL

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